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## Patent Public Search | Text View

|                      |                       |
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| United States Patent | 12411505              |
| Kind Code            | B2                    |
| Date of Patent       | September 09, 2025    |
| Inventor(s)          | Simon; Andreas et al. |

### Adaptive acceleration for materials handling vehicle

#### Abstract

A method is provided for operating a materials handling vehicle comprising: monitoring, by a processor, vehicle acceleration in a direction of travel of the vehicle during a manual operation by an operator of the vehicle when the vehicle is traveling in a first vehicle orientation; collecting and storing, by the processor, data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration; receiving, by the processor, a request to implement a semi-automated driving operation; calculating, by the processor, a maximum vehicle acceleration based on acceleration data comprising the stored data, wherein the data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration used in calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration comprises only the vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle collected when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation. Based at least in part on the maximum vehicle acceleration, controlling, by the processor, implementation of the semi-automated driving operation.

|            |                                                                                                    |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
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| Appl. No.: | 18/741989                                                                                          |
| Filed:     | June 13, 2024                                                                                      |

#### Prior Publication Data

| Document Identifier | Publication Date |
|---------------------|------------------|
| US 20240329671 A1   | Oct. 03, 2024    |

#### Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17443044 20210720 US 12066844 child-doc US 18741989  
us-provisional-application US 63109069 20201103

#### Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G05D13/62 (20060101); B60K31/00 (20060101); B62B5/00 (20060101); B66F9/075 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC G05D13/62 (20130101); B60K31/0058 (20130101); B62B5/0069 (20130101); B66F9/07572 (20130101); B66F9/07581 (20130101)

#### Field of Classification Search

CPC: G05D (1/0033); G05D (1/0061); G05D (1/0066); G05D (1/81); G05D (1/83); G05D (13/62); B60K (31/0058); B62B (5/0069); B66F (9/0755); B66F (9/07572); B66F (9/0753); B66F (9/07581); B66F (9/24); B66F (17/003)

USPC: 701/93

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## Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/443,044, filed Jul. 20, 2021, entitled “ADAPTIVE ACCELERATION FOR MATERIALS HANDLING VEHICLE,” which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/109,069, filed Nov. 3, 2020, entitled “ADAPTIVE ACCELERATION FOR MATERIALS HANDLING VEHICLE,” both of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety.

### BACKGROUND

(1) Materials handling vehicles are commonly used for picking stock in warehouses and distribution centers. Such vehicles typically include a power unit and a load handling assembly, which may include load carrying forks. The vehicle also has control structures for controlling operation and movement of the vehicle.

(2) In a typical stock picking operation, an operator fills orders from available stock items that are located in storage areas provided along one or more aisles of a warehouse or distribution center. The operator drives the vehicle between various pick locations where item(s) are to be picked. The operator may drive the vehicle either by using the control structures on the vehicle, or via a wireless remote control device that is associated with the vehicle.

### BRIEF SUMMARY

(3) In accordance with a first aspect, a method is provided for operating a materials handling vehicle comprising: monitoring, by a processor, vehicle acceleration in a direction of travel of the vehicle during a manual operation by an operator of the vehicle when the vehicle is traveling in a first vehicle orientation; collecting and storing, by the processor, data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle comprising data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation during the manual operation; receiving, by the processor, a request to implement a semi-automated driving operation; calculating, by the processor, a maximum vehicle acceleration based on acceleration data comprising the stored data, wherein the data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle used in calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration comprises only the vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle collected when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation. Based at least in part on the maximum vehicle acceleration, controlling, by the processor, implementation of the semi-automated driving operation.

(4) Vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in a second vehicle orientation, which is substantially 180 degrees different from the first vehicle orientation, may not be used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration.

(5) The vehicle may comprise a load handling assembly comprising at least one fork and a load support extending generally transverse to the at least one fork. The load support may be adapted to support a load carried by the at least one fork when the vehicle is accelerating while traveling in a second orientation and decelerating while traveling in the first orientation, wherein the second orientation may be substantially 180 degrees different than the first orientation.

(6) The materials handling vehicle may comprise a load handling assembly and a power unit, the first orientation comprises a power unit first direction.

(7) The method may further comprise: detecting, by the processor, operation of the vehicle indicative of a start of a pick operation occurring during the manual operation of the vehicle; and based on detecting the start of the pick operation, resetting, by the processor, the stored data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration. Preferably, the maximum vehicle acceleration is calculated by the processor based only on the acceleration data collected and stored after the resetting by the processor.

(8) In accordance with a second aspect, a method is provided for operating a materials handling vehicle comprising: monitoring, by a processor, vehicle acceleration in a direction of travel of the vehicle during a manual operation by an operator of the vehicle when traveling in a first vehicle orientation; monitoring, by the processor, vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle during the manual operation by the operator of the vehicle when traveling in a second vehicle orientation; collecting and storing, by the processor, first data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle comprising data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation and second data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle comprising data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the second vehicle orientation; receiving, by the processor, a request to implement a semi-automated driving operation; and calculating, by the processor, a maximum vehicle acceleration based on the stored first and second data, wherein the first data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle used in calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration comprises only the vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle collected when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation and wherein the second data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle used in calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration comprises only the vehicle deceleration data collected in the direction of travel of the

vehicle when the vehicle is traveling in the second vehicle orientation. Based at least in part on the maximum vehicle acceleration, controlling, by the processor, implementation of the semi-automated driving operation.

(9) Vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in the second vehicle orientation may not be used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration. Vehicle deceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation may not be used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration.

(10) The vehicle may comprise a load handling assembly comprising at least one fork and a load support extending generally transverse to the at least one fork, wherein the load support is adapted to support a load carried by the at least one fork when the vehicle is accelerating while traveling in a second orientation and decelerating while traveling in the first orientation, wherein the second vehicle orientation is substantially 180 degrees different than the first vehicle orientation.

(11) The materials handling vehicle may comprise a load handling assembly and a power unit, the first vehicle orientation may comprise a power unit first direction and the second vehicle orientation may comprise a load handling assembly first direction.

(12) The method may further comprise: detecting, by the processor, operation of the vehicle indicative of a start of a pick operation occurring during the manual operation of the vehicle; and based on detecting the start of the pick operation, resetting, by the processor, the stored first and second data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration and deceleration.

(13) The maximum vehicle acceleration may be calculated by the processor based only on the first and second data stored after the resetting by the processor.

(14) In accordance with a third aspect, a system is provided for operating a materials handling vehicle comprising: a memory storing executable instructions; and a processor in communication with the memory. Execution of the executable instructions by the processor may cause the processor to: monitor vehicle acceleration in a direction of travel of the vehicle during a manual operation by an operator of the vehicle when the vehicle is traveling in a first orientation; collect and store data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle comprising data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation during the manual operation; receive a request to implement a semi-automated driving operation; calculate a maximum vehicle acceleration based on acceleration data comprising the stored data, wherein the data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle used in calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration comprises only the vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle collected when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation; and control implementation of the semi-automated driving operation based at least in part on the maximum vehicle acceleration.

(15) Vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in a second vehicle orientation, which is substantially 180 degrees different from the first vehicle orientation, may not be used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration.

(16) The vehicle may comprise a load handling assembly comprising at least one fork and a load support extending generally transverse to the at least one fork. The load support may be adapted to support a load carried by the at least one fork when the vehicle is accelerating while traveling in a second vehicle orientation and decelerating while traveling in the first orientation, wherein the second vehicle orientation may be substantially 180 degrees different than the first vehicle orientation.

(17) The materials handling vehicle may comprise a load handling assembly and a power unit.

(18) The first vehicle orientation may comprise a power unit first direction.

(19) Execution of the executable instructions by the processor may cause the processor to: detect operation of the vehicle indicative of a start of a pick operation occurring during the manual operation of the vehicle; and reset the stored data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration based on detecting the start of the pick operation.

(20) Execution of the executable instructions by the processor may cause the processor to calculate the maximum vehicle acceleration based only on the acceleration data stored after the resetting of the stored data.

(21) Execution of the executable instructions by the processor may cause the processor to: monitor vehicle acceleration along a transverse direction to the direction of travel of the vehicle during the manual operation of the vehicle and collect and store data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the transverse direction. When calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration, the data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the transverse direction may be used.

(22) The vehicle acceleration along the transverse direction may be monitored when the vehicle is traveling in the first orientation, a second vehicle orientation, which is substantially 180 degrees different from the first vehicle orientation, or both the first and second orientations.

(23) In accordance with a fourth aspect, a system is provided for operating a materials handling vehicle comprising: a memory storing executable instructions; and a processor in communication with the memory. Execution of the executable instructions by the processor may cause the processor to: monitor vehicle acceleration in a direction of travel of the vehicle during a manual operation by an operator of the vehicle when traveling in a first vehicle orientation; monitor vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle during the manual operation by the operator of the vehicle when traveling in a second vehicle orientation; collect and store first data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle comprising data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation and second data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle comprising data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the second vehicle orientation; receive a request to implement a semi-automated driving operation; calculate a maximum vehicle acceleration based on the stored first and second data, wherein the first data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle used in calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration comprises only the vehicle acceleration data collected when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation and wherein the second data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle used in calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration comprises only the vehicle deceleration data collected when the vehicle is traveling in the second vehicle orientation; and control implementation of the semi-automated driving operation based at least in part on the maximum vehicle acceleration.

(24) Vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in the second vehicle orientation may not be used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration.

(25) Vehicle deceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation may not be used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration.

(26) The vehicle may comprise a load handling assembly comprising at least one fork and a load support extending generally transverse to the at least one fork, wherein the load support may be adapted to support a load carried by the at least one fork when the vehicle is accelerating while traveling in a second orientation and decelerating while traveling in the first orientation, wherein the second vehicle orientation is substantially 180 degrees different than the first vehicle orientation.

(27) The materials handling vehicle may comprise a load handling assembly and a power unit.

(28) The first vehicle orientation may comprise a power unit first direction and the second vehicle orientation may comprise a load handling assembly first direction.

(29) Execution of the executable instructions by the processor may cause the processor to: detect operation of the vehicle indicative of a start of a pick operation occurring during the manual operation of the vehicle; and based on detecting the start of the pick operation, resetting the stored first and second data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration.

(30) The maximum vehicle acceleration may be calculated by the processor based only on the first and second data stored after the resetting by the processor.

## Description

### BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIGS. 1A-1C are illustrations of a materials handling vehicle capable of remote wireless operation according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;
- (2) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of several components of a materials handling vehicle capable of remote wireless operation according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;
- (3) FIG. 3 depicts a flowchart of an example algorithm for monitoring first and second drive parameters during a most recent manual operation of the vehicle and, based on the first and second drive parameters, controlling implementation of a semi-automated driving operation according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;
- (4) FIG. 4 depicts a flowchart of an example algorithm for calculating a first value indicative of acceleration of the vehicle in a first direction during a most recent manual operation of the vehicle according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;
- (5) FIG. 5 illustrates a table containing non-real sample acceleration values in the first direction corresponding to a most recent manual operation of the vehicle according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;
- (6) FIG. 6 illustrates a table containing sample values of wax-i according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;
- (7) FIG. 7 depicts a flowchart of an example algorithm for calculating a second value indicative of acceleration of the vehicle in a second direction during a most recent manual operation of the vehicle according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;
- (8) FIG. 8 illustrates a table containing non-real sample acceleration values in the second direction corresponding to a most recent manual operation of the vehicle according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;
- (9) FIG. 9 illustrates a table containing sample values of way-i according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;
- (10) FIG. 10 depicts a flowchart of an example algorithm for calculating a maximum acceleration to be used during a next semi-automated driving operation based on the first and second values indicative of acceleration of the vehicle in the first and second directions during the prior manual operation of the vehicle according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;
- (11) FIG. 11 depicts a lookup table containing three separate ranges for the maximum acceleration in the second direction (ay-max) according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein; and
- (12) FIG. 12 depicts a flowchart of an example algorithm for resetting stored data related to the monitored first vehicle drive parameter based on detecting the start of the pick operation, according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein.
- (13) FIG. 13-FIG. 15 depict a sequence of vehicle operations indicative of the start of a pick operation during a manual operation of the vehicle according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;
- (14) FIGS. 16-19 depict four different orientations in which a vehicle can travel according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;
- (15) FIG. 20 is a flowchart of an example process for calculating a maximum vehicle acceleration for a semi-automated driving operation according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;
- (16) FIG. 21 is a flowchart of an example process for calculating a maximum vehicle acceleration for a semi-automated driving operation according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein; and
- (17) FIG. 22 is a flowchart of an example process for resetting stored acceleration-related data according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein.

### DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(18) In the following detailed description of the illustrated embodiments, reference is made to the accompanying drawings that form a part hereof, and in which is shown by way of illustration, and not by way of limitation. It is to be understood that other embodiments may be utilized and that changes may be made without departing from the spirit and scope of various embodiments illustrated herein.

(19) Low Level Order Picking Truck

(20) Referring now to the drawings, and particularly to FIGS. 1A, 1B and 1C, a materials handling vehicle, which is illustrated as a low level order picking truck 10, includes in general a load handling assembly 12 that extends from a power unit 14. The load handling assembly 12 includes a pair of forks 16, each fork 16 having a load supporting wheel assembly 18, and a vertical back cover 17 located at a base of the forks 16 near the power unit 14, which may define a load support. The load handling assembly 12 may include other load handling features in addition to, or in lieu of the illustrated arrangement of the forks 16, such as a scissors-type elevating forks, outriggers or separate height adjustable forks. Still further, the load handling assembly 12 may include load handling features such as a mast, a load platform, collection cage or other support structure carried by the forks 16 or otherwise provided for handling a load supported and carried by the truck 10 or pushed or pulled by the truck, i.e., such as by a tugger vehicle.

(21) The illustrated power unit 14 comprises a step-through operator's station 30 dividing a first end section 14A of the power unit 14 (opposite the forks 16) from a second end section 14B (proximate the forks 16). The step-through operator's station 30 provides a platform 32 upon which an operator may stand to drive the truck 10 and/or to provide a position from which the operator may operate the various included features of the truck 10.

(22) A first work area is provided towards the first end section 14A of the power unit 14 and includes a control area 40 for driving the truck 10 when the operator is standing on the platform 32 and for controlling the features of the load handling assembly 12. The first end section 14A defines a compartment 48 for containing a battery, control electronics, including a controller 103 (see FIG. 2), and motor(s), such as a traction motor, steer motor and lift motor for the forks (not shown).

(23) As shown for purposes of illustration, and not by way of limitation, the control area 40 comprises a handle 52 for steering the truck 10, which may include controls such as grips, butterfly switches, thumbwheels, rocker switches, a hand wheel, a steering tiller, etc., for controlling the acceleration/braking and travel direction of the truck 10, see FIGS. 1A and 1B. For example, as shown, a control such as a switch grip or travel switch 54 may be provided on the handle 52, which is spring biased to a center neutral position. Rotating the travel switch 54 forward and upward will cause the truck 10 to move forward, e.g., power unit first, at an acceleration proportional to the amount of rotation of the travel switch 54 until the truck 10 reaches a predefined maximum speed, at which point the truck 10 is no longer permitted to accelerate to a higher speed. For example, if the travel switch 54 is very quickly rotated 50% of a maximum angle of rotation capable for the grip 54, the truck 10 will accelerate at approximately 50% of the maximum acceleration capable for the truck until the truck reaches 50% of the maximum speed capable for the truck. It is also contemplated that acceleration may be determined using an acceleration map stored in memory where the rotation angle of the grip 54 is used as an input into and has a corresponding acceleration value in the acceleration map. The acceleration values in the acceleration map corresponding to the grip rotation angles may be proportional to the grip rotation angles or vary in any desired manner. There may also be a velocity map stored in memory where the rotation angle of the grip 54 is used as an input into and has a corresponding maximum velocity value stored in the velocity map. For example, when the grip 54 is rotated 50% of the maximum angle capable for the grip 54, the truck will accelerate at a corresponding acceleration value stored in the acceleration map to a maximum velocity value stored in the velocity map corresponding to the grip angle of 50% of the maximum angle. Similarly, rotating the travel switch 54 toward the rear and downward of the truck 10 will cause the truck 10 to move in reverse, e.g., forks

first, at an acceleration proportional to the amount of rotation of the travel switch **54** until the truck **10** reaches a predefined maximum speed corresponding to the amount of rotation of the travel switch **54**, at which point the truck **10** is no longer permitted to accelerate to a higher speed.

(24) Presence sensors **58** may be provided to detect the presence of an operator on the truck **10**. For example, presence sensors **58** may be located on, above or under the platform floor, or otherwise provided about the operator's station **30**. In the exemplary truck **10** of FIG. **1A**, the presence sensors **58** are shown in dashed lines indicating that they are positioned under the platform floor. Under this arrangement, the presence sensors **58** may comprise load sensors, switches, etc. As an alternative, the presence sensors **58** may be implemented above the platform floor, such as by using ultrasonic, capacitive, laser scanner, camera or other suitable sensing technology. The utilization of presence sensors **58** will be described in greater detail herein.

(25) An antenna **66** extends vertically from the power unit **14** and is provided for receiving control signals from a corresponding wireless remote control device **70**. It is also contemplated that the antenna **66** may be provided within the compartment **48** of the power unit **14** or elsewhere on the truck **10**. According to one embodiment, the truck **10** may include a pole (not shown) that extends vertically from the power unit **14** and includes an antenna **66** that is provided for receiving control signals from a corresponding wireless remote control device **70**. The pole may include a light at the top, such that the pole and light define a light tower. The remote control device **70** may comprise a transmitter that is worn or otherwise maintained by the operator. The remote control device **70** is manually operable by an operator, e.g., by pressing a button or other control, to cause the remote control device **70** to wirelessly transmit at least a first type of signal designating a travel request to the truck **10**. The travel request command that requests the corresponding truck **10** to travel by a predetermined amount, as will be described in greater detail herein.

(26) The truck **10** also comprises one or more obstacle sensors **76**, which are provided about the truck **10**, e.g., towards the first end section of the power unit **14** and/or to the sides of the power unit **14**. The obstacle sensors **76** include at least one contactless obstacle sensor on the truck **10**, and are operable to define at least one detection zone. For example, at least one detection zone may define an area at least partially in front of a forward traveling direction of the truck **10** when the truck **10** is traveling in response to a wirelessly received travel request from the remote control device **70**.

(27) The obstacle sensors **76** may comprise any suitable proximity detection technology, such as ultrasonic sensors, optical recognition devices, infrared sensors, laser scanner sensors, etc., which are capable of detecting the presence of objects/obstacles or are capable of generating signals that can be analyzed to detect the presence of objects/obstacles within the predefined detection zone(s) of the power unit **14**.

(28) In practice, the truck **10** may be implemented in other formats, styles and features, such as an end control pallet truck that includes a steering tiller arm that is coupled to a tiller handle for steering the truck. Similarly, although the remote control device **70** is illustrated as a glove-like structure **70**, numerous implementations of the remote control device **70** may be implemented, including for example, finger worn, lanyard or sash mounted, etc. Still further, the truck, remote control system and/or components thereof, including the remote control device **70**, may comprise any additional and/or alternative features or implementations.

(29) Control System for Remote Operation of a Low Level Order Picking Truck

(30) Referring to FIG. **2**, a block diagram illustrates a control arrangement for integrating remote control commands with the truck **10**. The antenna **66** is coupled to a receiver **102** for receiving commands issued by the remote control device **70**. The receiver **102** passes the received control signals to the controller **103**, which implements the appropriate response to the received commands and may thus also be referred to herein as a master controller. In this regard, the controller **103** is implemented in hardware and may also execute software (including firmware, resident software, micro-code, etc.) Furthermore, embodiments may take the form of a computer program product embodied in one or more computer readable medium(s) having computer readable program code embodied thereon.

(31) Thus, the controller **103** may comprise an electronic controller defining, at least in part, a data processing system suitable for storing and/or executing program code and may include at least one processor **103A** coupled directly or indirectly to memory elements, e.g., through a system bus or other suitable connection. The memory elements can include local memory employed during actual execution of the program code, memory that is integrated into a microcontroller or application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a programmable gate array or other reconfigurable processing device, etc. The at least one processor may include any processing component operable to receive and execute executable instructions (such as program code from one or more memory elements). The at least one processor may comprise any kind of a device which receives input data, processes that data through computer instructions, and generates output data. Such a processor can be a microcontroller, a hand-held device, laptop or notebook computer, desktop computer, microcomputer, digital signal processor (DSP), mainframe, server, cell phone, personal digital assistant, other programmable computer devices, or any combination thereof. Such processors can also be implemented using programmable logic devices such as field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs) or, alternatively, realized as application specific integrated circuits (ASICs) or similar devices. The term "processor" is also intended to encompass a combination of two or more of the above recited devices, e.g., two or more microcontrollers.

(32) The response implemented by the controller **103** in response to wirelessly received commands, e.g., via the wireless transmitter of the remote control device **70** and corresponding antennae **66** and receiver **102**, may comprise one or more actions, or inactions, depending upon the logic that is being implemented. Positive actions may comprise controlling, adjusting or otherwise affecting one or more components of the truck **10**. The controller **103** may also receive information from other inputs **104**, e.g., from sources such as the presence sensors **58**, the obstacle sensors **76**, switches, load sensors, encoders and other devices/features available to the truck **10** to determine appropriate action in response to the received commands from the remote control device **70**. The sensors **58**, **76**, etc. may be coupled to the controller **103** via the inputs **104** or via a suitable truck network, such as a control area network (CAN) bus **110**.

(33) A further input into the controller **103** may be a weight signal generated by a load sensor LS, such as a conventional pressure transducer, see FIG. **2**, which senses the combined weight of the forks **16** and any load on the forks **16**. The load sensor LS may be incorporated into a hydraulic system for effecting lift of the forks **16**. By subtracting the weight of the forks **16** (a known constant value) from the combined weight of the forks **16** and a load L on the forks **16**, which combined weight is defined by the weight signal from the load sensor LS, the controller **103** determines the weight of the load L on the forks **16**. Alternatively, in place of the pressure transducer LS incorporated into the hydraulic system, one or more weight sensing cells (not shown) may be integrated into the forks **16** to sense a load L on the forks **16** and generate a corresponding load sensing signal to the controller **103**.

(34) The controller **103** is also capable of determining the vertical location, i.e., height, of the load handling assembly **12** including the forks **16** relative to ground, such as a floor surface along which the truck **10** travels, as follows. One or more height sensors or switches may be provided in the second end section **14B** of the power unit **14**, which sense when the load handling assembly **12** including the forks **16** is raised vertically relative to ground and/or a lower point on the first end section **14A** of the power unit **14**. For example, first, second and third switches (not shown) may be provided within the second end section **14B** at first, second and third vertical locations, designated by dotted lines **141A**, **141B** and **141C** in FIG. **1A**, which switches are actuated as the load handling assembly **12** is raised. A lowermost position of the load handling assembly **12** may also be determined via the load sensor LS indicating a zero weight.

(35) In one embodiment, the controller **103** may comprise one or more accelerometers which may measure physical acceleration of the truck **10** along one, two or three axes. It is also contemplated that the accelerometer **1103** may be separate from the controller **103** but coupled to and in communication with the controller **103** for generating and transmitting to the controller **103** acceleration signals, see FIG. **2**. For example, the accelerometer **1103** may measure the acceleration of the truck **10** in a direction of travel DT (also referred to herein as a first direction of travel) of the truck **10**, which, in the FIG. **1A** embodiment, is collinear with an axis X, which X axis may be generally parallel with the forks **16**. The direction of travel DT or first direction of travel may be defined as the direction in which the truck **10** is moving, either in a forward or power unit first direction or a reverse or forks first direction.

(36) The accelerometer **1103** may further measure the acceleration of the truck **10** along a transverse direction TR (also referred to herein as a second



direction) generally 90 degrees to the direction of travel DT of the truck **10**, which transverse direction TR, in the FIG. 1A embodiment, is collinear with an axis Y. The accelerometer **1103** may also measure the acceleration of the truck **10** in a further direction transverse to both the direction of travel DT and the transverse direction TR, which further direction is generally collinear with a Z axis.

(37) In an exemplary arrangement, the remote control device **70** is operative to wirelessly transmit a control signal that represents a first type signal such as a travel command to the receiver **102** on the truck **10**. The travel command is also referred to herein as a “travel signal”, “travel request” or “go signal”. The travel request is used to initiate a request to the truck **10** to travel by a predetermined amount, e.g., to cause the truck **10** to advance or jog, typically only in the power unit first direction, by a limited travel distance. The limited travel distance may be defined by an approximate travel distance, travel time or other measure. In one implementation, the truck may be driven continuously as long as an operator provides a travel request not lasting longer than a predetermined time amount, e.g., 20 seconds. After the operator no longer provides a travel request or if the travel request has been provided for more than the predetermined time period, a traction motor effecting truck movement is no longer activated and the truck is permitted to coast to a stop. The truck **10** may be controlled to travel in a generally straight direction or along a previously determined heading.

(38) Thus, a first type signal received by the receiver **102** is communicated to the controller **103**. If the controller **103** determines that the travel signal is a valid travel signal and that the current vehicle conditions are appropriate (explained in greater detail below), the controller **103** sends a signal to the appropriate control configuration of the particular truck **10** to advance and then stop the truck **10**. Stopping the truck **10** may be implemented, for example, by either allowing the truck **10** to coast to a stop or by initiating a brake operation to cause the truck **10** to brake to a stop.

(39) As an example, the controller **103** may be communicably coupled to a traction control system, illustrated as a traction motor controller **106** of the truck **10**. The traction motor controller **106** is coupled to a traction motor **107** that drives at least one driven wheel **108** of the truck **10**. The controller **103** may communicate with the traction motor controller **106** so as to accelerate, decelerate, adjust and/or otherwise limit the speed of the truck **10** in response to receiving a travel request from the remote control device **70**. The controller **103** may also be communicably coupled to a steer controller **112**, which is coupled to a steer motor **114** that steers at least one steered wheel **108** of the truck **10**, wherein the steered wheel may be different from the driven wheel. In this regard, the truck **10** may be controlled by the controller **103** to travel an intended path or maintain an intended heading in response to receiving a travel request from the remote control device **70**.

(40) The controller **103** may determine whether the truck **10** is moving or stopped and a linear distance that the truck **10** has travelled as follows. First, the controller **103** may determine whether the truck **10** is moving or stopped using the signals generated by the accelerometer **1103** and integrating once. It is also possible to determine if the truck **10** is moving by determining if the current value from the accelerometer **1103** is greater than zero. The controller **103** may also determine the linear distance that the truck **10** has travelled using the signals generated by the accelerometer **1103** and integrating twice. Alternatively, the traction controller **106** may receive feedback signals generated by an encoder within the traction motor **107** and from those signals generate a motor angular velocity signal to the controller **103**. The controller **103** may determine whether the vehicle is moving or stopped from the motor angular velocity signal. The controller **103** may also convert the motor angular velocity signal to an actual linear speed of the vehicle **10**. If, for example, the velocity signal comprises an angular speed of the traction motor **107**, then the controller **103** may scale that value to an actual linear speed of the vehicle **10** based on a) a gearing ratio between the traction motor **107** and a driven wheel of the vehicle and b) the circumference of the driven wheel. The linear speed of the vehicle may then be used (via integration) to determine a distance that the truck **10** has travelled.

(41) As yet another illustrative example, the controller **103** may also communicate with the traction controller **106** to decelerate, stop or otherwise control the speed of the truck **10** in response to receiving a travel request from the remote control device **70**. Braking may be effected by the traction controller **106** by causing regenerative braking or activating a mechanical brake **117** coupled to the traction motor **107**, see FIG. 2. Still further, the controller **103** may be communicably coupled to other vehicle features, such as main contactors **118**, and/or other outputs **119** associated with the truck **10**, where applicable, to implement desired actions in response to implementing remote travel functionality.

(42) According to embodiments, the controller **103** may communicate with the receiver **102** and with the traction controller **106** to operate the truck **10** under remote control in response to receiving travel commands from the associated remote control device **70**.

(43) Correspondingly, if the truck **10** is moving in response to a command received by remote wireless control, the controller **103** may dynamically alter, control, adjust or otherwise affect the remote control operation, e.g., by stopping the truck **10**, changing the steer angle of the truck **10**, or taking other actions. Thus, the particular vehicle features, the state/condition of one or more vehicle features, vehicle environment, etc., may influence the manner in which controller **103** responds to travel requests from the remote control device **70**.

(44) The controller **103** may refuse to acknowledge a received travel request depending upon predetermined condition(s), e.g., that relate to environmental or/operational factor(s). For example, the controller **103** may disregard an otherwise valid travel request based upon information obtained from one or more of the sensors **58**, **76**. As an illustration, according to embodiments, the controller **103** may optionally consider factors such as whether an operator is on the truck **10** when determining whether to respond to a travel command from the remote control device **70**. As noted above, the truck **10** may comprise at least one presence sensor **58** for detecting whether an operator is positioned on the truck **10**. In this regard, the controller **103** may be further configured to respond to a travel request to operate the truck **10** under remote control when the presence sensor(s) **58** designate that no operator is on the truck **10**. Thus, in this implementation, the truck **10** cannot be operated in response to wireless commands from the transmitter unless the operator is physically off of the truck **10**. Similarly, if the object sensors **76** detect that an object, including the operator, is adjacent and/or proximate to the truck **10**, the controller **103** may refuse to acknowledge a travel request from the transmitter **70**. Thus, in an exemplary implementation, an operator must be located within a limited range of the truck **10**, e.g., close enough to the truck **10** to be in wireless communication range (which may be limited to set a maximum distance of the operator from the truck **10**). Other arrangements may alternatively be implemented.

(45) Any other number of reasonable conditions, factors, parameters or other considerations may also/alternatively be implemented by the controller **103** to interpret and take action in response to received signals from the transmitter.

(46) Upon acknowledgement of a travel request, the controller **103** interacts with the traction motor controller **106**, e.g., directly or indirectly, e.g., via a bus such as the CAN bus **110** if utilized, to advance the truck **10** by a limited amount. Depending upon the particular implementation, the controller **103** may interact with the traction motor controller **106** and optionally, the steer controller **112**, to advance the truck **10** by a predetermined distance. Alternatively, the controller **103** may interact with the traction motor controller **106** and optionally, the steer controller **112**, to advance the truck **10** for a period of time in response to the detection and maintained actuation of a travel control on the remote **70**. As yet another illustrative example, the truck **10** may be configured to jog for as long as a travel control signal is received. Still further, the controller **103** may be configured to “time out” and stop the travel of the truck **10** based upon a predetermined event, such as exceeding a predetermined time period or travel distance regardless of the detection of maintained actuation of a corresponding control on the remote control device **70**.

(47) The remote control device **70** may also be operative to transmit a second type signal, such as a “stop signal”, designating that the truck **10** should brake and/or otherwise come to rest. The second type signal may also be implied, e.g., after implementing a “travel” command, e.g., after the truck **10** has traveled a predetermined distance, traveled for a predetermined time, etc., under remote control in response to the travel command. If the controller **103** determines that a wirelessly received signal is a stop signal, the controller **103** sends a signal to the traction controller **106** and/or other truck component to bring the truck **10** to a rest. As an alternative to a stop signal, the second type signal may comprise a “coast signal” or a “controlled deceleration signal” designating that the truck **10** should coast, eventually slowing to rest.

(48) The time that it takes to bring the truck **10** to a complete rest may vary, depending for example, upon the intended application, the environmental conditions, the capabilities of the particular truck **10**, the load on the truck **10** and other similar factors. For example, after completing an appropriate

jog movement, it may be desirable to allow the truck **10** to “coast” some distance before coming to rest so that the truck **10** stops slowly. This may be achieved by utilizing regenerative braking to slow the truck **10** to a stop. Alternatively, a braking operation may be applied after a predetermined delay time to allow a predetermined range of additional travel to the truck **10** after the initiation of the stop operation. It may also be desirable to bring the truck **10** to a relatively quicker stop, e.g., if an object is detected in the travel path of the truck **10** or if an immediate stop is desired after a successful jog operation. For example, the controller may apply predetermined torque to the braking operation. Under such conditions, the controller **103** may instruct the traction controller **106** to brake via regenerative braking or applying the mechanical brake **117** to stop the truck **10**.

(49) Calculating Vehicle Drive Parameter(s) for Use During Remote Control Operation of Vehicle

(50) As noted above, an operator may stand on the platform **32** within the operator's station **30** to manually operate the truck **10**, i.e., operate the truck in a manual mode. The operator may steer the truck **10** via the handle **52**, see FIG. **1B**, and, further, may cause the truck **10** to accelerate via rotation of the travel switch **54**. As also noted above, rotation of the travel switch **54** forward and upward will cause the truck **10** to move forward, e.g., power unit first, at an acceleration that may be proportional to the amount of rotation of the travel switch **54**. Similarly, rotating the travel switch **54** toward the rear and downward of the truck **10** will cause the truck **10** to move in reverse, e.g., forks first, at an acceleration that may be proportional to the amount of rotation of the travel switch **54**. Rotation of the travel switch **54** forward and upward while the truck **10** is moving in the forks first direction will cause the truck **10** to brake. Also, rotating the travel switch **54** toward the rear and downward while the truck **10** is moving in the power unit first direction will cause the truck **10** to brake. Hence, “manual operation of the vehicle by an operator” occurs when an operator is standing on the platform **32** within the operator's station **30** and steering the truck **10** via the handle **52** and accelerating/braking (i.e., regenerative braking) the truck via rotation of the travel switch **54**. A separate brake switch, for example switch **41** of FIG. **1B**, can be used by the operator to cause regenerative braking of the truck **10**. As noted above, braking may also be effected via the mechanical brake.

(51) As also noted above, the controller **103** may communicate with the receiver **102** and with the traction controller **106** to operate the truck **10** under remote control in response to receiving travel commands from the associated remote control device **70**. The travel request is used to initiate a request to the truck **10** to travel by a predetermined amount, e.g., to cause the truck **10** to advance or jog in the first direction of travel, i.e., in the power unit first direction, by a limited travel distance. Hence, the operator may operate the truck **10** in a remote control mode when the operator is not physically present on the truck but is walking near the truck **10** such as during a picking operation, i.e., when the operator is located off the truck **10** and picking or gathering pick items from warehouse storage areas to be loaded on the truck **10**, using the remote control device **70** to operate the truck **10** under remote control. Operating the truck **10** in the remote control mode is also referred to herein as “semi-automated” operation of the truck **10**.

(52) When an operator is using the truck **10**, such as during a picking operation within a warehouse, the operator typically uses the truck **10** in both the manual mode and the remote control mode.

(53) Previously, a vehicle controller stored a predefined, fixed vehicle parameter, e.g., a maximum acceleration, to limit the maximum acceleration of the vehicle during operation of the vehicle in the remote control mode. This predefined maximum acceleration limit was sometimes too high, e.g., if the truck was being loaded with a tall stack of articles/packages defining loads that were unstable, and too low if the truck was being loaded with a short stack of articles/packages defining loads that were stable.

(54) In accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure, the controller **103** monitors one or more drive parameters during a most recent manual operation of the truck **10**, in which one or more drive parameters correspond to a driving behavior or trait of an operator of the truck **10**. If the one or more drive parameters are high, this may correspond to the operator driving the truck **10** briskly. If the one or more drive parameters are low, this may correspond to the operator driving the truck **10** conservatively or cautiously. Instead of using one or more predefined, fixed drive parameters for vehicle control during remote control operation of the truck **10**, the controller **103** calculates one or more adaptive drive parameters for use during a next remote control operation of the truck **10** based on the one or more drive parameters monitored during a most recent manual operation of the truck **10**. Since the one or more drive parameters calculated for use in the next remote control operation of the truck **10** are based on recent driving behavior of the operator, i.e., the one or more drive parameters monitored during the most recent manual mode operation of the truck **10**, it is believed that the controller **103** more accurately and appropriately defines the one or more drive parameters to be used during a next remote control operation of the truck **10** such that the one or more drive parameters more closely match to the most recent driving behavior of the operator.

(55) An example control algorithm, or process, for the controller **103** is illustrated in FIG. **3** for monitoring first and second drive parameters, e.g., acceleration in first and second directions, during a most recent manual operation of the truck **10** to calculate a corresponding adaptive drive parameter, e.g., a maximum acceleration, to be used by the controller **103** when the truck **10** is next operated in the remote control mode.

(56) In step **201**, the controller **103** monitors concurrently during a most recent manual operation of the vehicle, a first drive parameter, e.g., a first acceleration, corresponding to a first direction of travel of the vehicle or truck **10** and a second drive parameter, e.g., a second acceleration, corresponding to a second direction, which is different from the first direction of travel. In the illustrated embodiment, the first direction of travel may be defined by the direction of travel DT of the truck **10**, see FIG. **1**, and the second direction may be defined by the transverse direction TR. Hence, the first and second directions may be substantially orthogonal to one another. The controller **103** replaces any stored data, i.e., first stored data, regarding the monitored first and second vehicle drive parameters corresponding to the previous manual operation of the vehicle by the operator with recent data, i.e., second data, regarding the monitored first and second vehicle drive parameters during the most recent manual operation of the vehicle, wherein the recent data is not calculated using or based on the previously stored data from the previous manual operation of the vehicle. The vehicle may have been operated in a remote control mode after the previous manual operation of the vehicle and before the most recent manual operation of the vehicle.

(57) An operator may vary acceleration of the truck **10** based on factors such as the curvature of the path along which the truck **10** is being driven, the turning angle of the truck **10**, the current floor conditions, e.g., a wet/slippy floor surface or a dry/non-slippy floor surface, and/or the weight and height of any load being carried by the truck **10**. For example, if the truck **10** is being driven without a load or with a stable load, e.g., the load has a low height, over a long, straight path, on a dry/non-slippy floor surface, then values for the first acceleration may be high. However, if the truck **10** has an unstable load, e.g., the load has a high height, such that the load may shift or fall from the truck **10** if the truck **10** is accelerated quickly, then values for the first acceleration may be low. Also, if the truck **10** is being turned at a sharp angle and driven at a high speed, then values for the first acceleration may be high and values for the second acceleration may also be high.

(58) In step **203**, the controller **103** receives, after the most recent manual operation of the vehicle or truck **10**, a request to implement a semi-automated driving operation, i.e., a request to operate the truck **10** in the remote control mode. In the illustrated embodiment and as discussed above, the controller **103** may receive a travel request from the remote control device **70**. Such a travel request may define a request to implement a first semi-automated driving operation.

(59) In step **205**, the controller **103**, based on the first and second monitored vehicle drive parameters during the most recent manual operation of the truck **10**, implements the semi-automated driving operation of the truck **10**. The controller **103**, based on the recent data regarding the monitored first and second vehicle drive parameters during the most recent manual operation of the vehicle, calculates a first value indicative of acceleration of the truck **10** in the first direction and a second value indicative of acceleration of the truck **10** in the second direction. The controller **103** modifies the first value indicative of acceleration in the first direction based on the second value indicative of acceleration in the second direction if the second value falls outside of a pre-defined range. The first value, whether modified or not based on whether the second value falls outside or within the pre-defined range, defines a maximum acceleration that cannot be exceeded during the semi-automated driving operation of the truck **10**.

(60) An example control algorithm, or process, for the controller **103** is illustrated in FIG. **4** for calculating a first value indicative of acceleration of the truck **10** in the first direction during the most recent manual operation of the truck **10**. In step **301**, a sequence of acceleration values in the first

direction from the accelerometer **1103** are collected during the most recent manual operation of the vehicle, where the first direction is defined by the direction of travel DT of the truck **10**, and stored in memory by the controller **103**. Rotation of the travel switch **54** forward and upward will cause the truck **10** to move forward, e.g., power unit first, at a positive acceleration in the power unit first direction proportional to the amount of rotation of the travel switch **54**. Similarly, rotating the travel switch **54** toward the rear and downward of the truck **10** will cause the truck **10** to move in reverse, e.g., forks first, at a positive acceleration in the forks first direction proportional to the amount of rotation of the travel switch **54**. As the truck **10** accelerates in either the power unit first direction or the forks first direction, both considered the first direction as defined by the direction of travel DT of the truck **10**, the accelerometer **1103** generates a sequence of positive acceleration values that are stored in memory by the controller **103**. Rotation of the travel switch **54** forward and upward while the truck **10** is moving in the forks first direction will cause the truck **10** to decelerate or brake. Also, rotating the travel switch **54** toward the rear and downward while the truck **10** is moving in the power unit first direction will cause the truck **10** to decelerate or brake. In accordance with a first embodiment, negative acceleration values, such as occurring during braking, are not collected for use in calculating the first value indicative of acceleration of the truck **10** in the first direction during the most recent manual operation of the vehicle.

(61) While rotation of the travel switch **54** forward and upward will cause the truck **10** to move forward, i.e., power unit first, at a positive acceleration (speed is increasing) in the power unit first direction, the accelerometer may determine that such movement comprises a positive acceleration. The accelerometer may also determine that braking (speed is decreasing) while the truck **10** is traveling in the power unit first direction comprises deceleration or negative acceleration. Further, while rotating the travel switch **54** toward the rear and downward will cause the truck **10** to move in reverse, e.g., forks first, at a positive acceleration (speed is increasing) in the forks first direction, the accelerometer may determine that such movement where the speed is increasing in the forks first direction comprises a negative acceleration. The accelerometer may also determine that braking (speed is decreasing) while the truck **10** is traveling in the forks first direction comprises a positive acceleration. However, for purposes of the discussion herein of a control algorithm for calculating a maximum acceleration to be used during a next semi-automated driving operation, acceleration and deceleration during movement of the truck **10** in the power unit first direction and the forks first direction will be defined as follows: rotation of the travel switch **54** forward and upward causing the truck **10** to move forward, e.g., power unit first, is defined as a positive acceleration (speed is increasing) in the power unit first direction; rotating the travel switch **54** toward the rear and downward causing the truck **10** to move in reverse, e.g., forks first, is defined as a positive acceleration (speed is increasing) in the forks first direction; rotation of the travel switch **54** forward and upward or actuating the brake switch **41** while the truck **10** is moving in the forks first direction causing the truck **10** to decelerate or brake (speed is decreasing) is defined as a negative acceleration or deceleration; and rotation of the travel switch **54** toward the rear and downward or actuation of the brake switch **41** while the truck **10** is moving in the power unit first direction causing the truck **10** to decelerate or brake (speed is decreasing) is defined as a negative acceleration or deceleration.

(62) As noted above, in accordance with a first embodiment, negative acceleration values, such as occurring during braking in either the power unit first direction or the forks first direction, are not collected for use in calculating the first value indicative of acceleration of the truck **10** in the first direction during the most recent manual operation of the vehicle. However, in accordance with a second embodiment, both positive acceleration values (where the speed of the truck is increasing in either the power unit first or the forks first direction) and negative acceleration values (where the speed of the truck is decreasing in either the power unit first or the forks first direction) are collected and used in calculating the first value indicative of acceleration of the truck **10** in the first direction during the most recent manual operation of the vehicle. In the second embodiment where negative acceleration values are collected, the absolute value of the negative acceleration values are used in the described equations and calculations set out below. Accordingly, while some embodiments may ignore any negative acceleration data, other embodiments can consider such data by using the absolute value of the negative acceleration data in the described equations and calculations.

(63) In step **303**, the acceleration values in the first direction collected during the most recent manual operation of the truck **10** are filtered with a weighted average equation so as to make maximum outliers less weighted and effect smoothing. Example equation 1, set out below, may be used to filter the collected acceleration values in the first direction to calculate weighted average values based on the collected acceleration values in the first direction from the most recent manual operation of the truck **10**.

$$(64) \quad wa_{x-(i+1)} = \frac{wa_{x-i} * g_1 + a_{x_{[(i*m)+1]}} * g_2 + a_{x_{[(i*m)+2]}} * g_3 + a_{x_{[(i*m)+3]}} * g_4}{\text{Math. } g_s} \quad \text{Equation 1} \quad wa_{\text{sub.x}-(i+1)} = \text{calculated weighted average in a first direction (e.g., "x"); where } i=1 \dots n$$

(n-1) and n is the total number of subsets into which the individual collected acceleration values, a.sub.x<sub>j</sub>, are grouped; wa.sub.x-i; where i=1 . . . n; wa.sub.x-I=arithmetic average of the first three "start" acceleration values in the first direction for the first calculation and thereafter the most recent weighted average; g.sub.s=weighting factor where s=1 . . . m+1, where m is the number of members in each subset; g.sub.1=weighting factor of wa<sub>x-i</sub>; in the illustrated embodiment, g.sub.1=3, but could be any value; g.sub.2, g.sub.3, g.sub.4=additional weighting factors=1, but could be any value and is typically less than g.sub.1; a.sub.x<sub>[(i\*m)+1]</sub>, a.sub.x<sub>[(i\*m)+2]</sub>, a.sub.x<sub>[(i\*m)+3]</sub>, where i=1 . . . (n-1); a.sub.x<sub>[(i\*m)+1]</sub>, a.sub.x<sub>[(i\*m)+2]</sub>, a.sub.x<sub>[(i\*m)+3]</sub>=three adjacent individual acceleration values in the first direction, defining a subset, collected during the most recent manual operation of the truck **10**. The subset could comprise more than three or less than three acceleration values. The first three collected acceleration values (a.sub.x<sub>1</sub>, a.sub.x<sub>2</sub>, and a.sub.x<sub>3</sub>) make up a first subset as well.

(65) The first "start" acceleration values in the first direction could comprise less than three or more than three values and the number of members in each subset "m" could likewise comprise less than three or more than three members.

(66) For purposes of illustration, sample calculations will now be provided based on non-real sample values, which simulate collected acceleration values in the first direction, and are set out in Table 1 of FIG. 5. All of the acceleration values set out in Table 1 are positive values. However, as noted above, negative acceleration values could be collected and used as well. As further noted above, where negative acceleration values are collected, the absolute value of the negative acceleration values are used in combination with the acceleration values in the described equations and calculations set out herein.

$$(67) \quad wa_{x-1} = \text{arithmetic average of the first three "start" acceleration values} = \frac{a_{x-1} + a_{x-2} + a_{x-3}}{m} = \frac{1+2+4}{3} = 2.33$$

$$Wa_{x-2} = \text{first weighted average value} = \frac{g_1 * wa_{x-1} + g_2 * a_{x-4} + g_3 * a_{x-5} + g_4 * a_{x-6}}{\text{Math. } g_s} = \frac{3 * 2.33 + 1 * 8 + 1 * 3 + 1 * 2}{6} = 3.33$$

$$a_{x-3} = \text{second weighted average value} = \frac{g_1 * wa_{x-2} + g_2 * a_{x-7} + g_3 * a_{x-8} + g_4 * a_{x-9}}{\text{Math. } g_s} = \frac{3 * 3.33 + 1 * 1 + 1 * 0 + 1 * 0}{6} = 1.83$$

(68) The remaining weighted average values based on the sample values set out in Table 1 of FIG. 5 are calculated in a similar manner. The results are set out in Table 2 of FIG. 6.

(69) Thus, with respect to Equation 1, the values a.sub.x<sub>[(i\*m)+1]</sub>, a.sub.x<sub>[(i\*m)+2]</sub>, and a.sub.x<sub>[(i\*m)+3]</sub> are used in the calculation of a weighted average value wa<sub>x-(i+1)</sub>. According to the example of FIG. 5, "i" can range from 1 to 9, but for purposes of Equation 1, "i" ranges from 1 to 8. Accordingly, the 27 acceleration values (i.e., a.sub.x<sub>j</sub>, "j"=27 individual collected acceleration values in the Example of FIG. 5) in the table of FIG. 5 can be arranged as 9 distinct subsets each having 3 elements. Other than the first subset, which, as noted above, comprise an arithmetic average of the first three "start" acceleration values in the first direction, for each of the subsequent 8 subsets, a weighted average is calculated according to Equation 1. The example initial arithmetic average and the example 8 weighted averages are shown in FIG. 6. One of ordinary skill will readily recognize that the subset size of 3 values is merely an example and that utilizing 9 subsets is an example amount as well.

(70) In step **305** of FIG. 4, a maximum acceleration in the first direction defined by the direction of travel DT of the truck **10** is determined using example Equation 2, set out below:

(71)

$a_{x-wa-max}$  = maximum acceleration in the first direction =  $\max(wa_{x-i})$  = maximum value of the initial arithmetic and weighted average values ( $wa_{x-i}$ ) calculated. Equation 3

(72) Based on the results from Table 2 of FIG. 6,  $\max(wa_{x-i}) = a_{x-8} = 3.82$ .

(73) It is noted that  $a_{x-wa-max}$  may be selected from any number of initial arithmetic and weighted average values ( $wa_{x-i}$ ) calculated. For example, the average values ( $wa_{x-i}$ ) calculated during a predetermined time period, e.g., the last ten seconds, may be considered. It is also contemplated that a predetermined number of initial arithmetic and weighted average values ( $wa_{x-i}$ ) calculated, e.g., 25 average values, without taking time into account, may be considered. It is further contemplated that all of the initial arithmetic and weighted average values ( $wa_{x-i}$ ) calculated during the entirety of the most recent manual operation of the truck 10 may be considered. In the illustrated example, nine (9) values of initial arithmetic and weighted averages ( $wa_{x-i}$ ) were considered. However, less than 9 or greater than 9 values of initial arithmetic and weighted averages ( $wa_{x-i}$ ) can be considered when selecting  $\max(a_{x-wa-i})$  = maximum value of the initial arithmetic and weighted averages ( $wa_{x-i}$ ) calculated, which defines the  $a_{x-wa-max}$  = maximum acceleration in the first direction. The maximum acceleration in the first direction ( $a_{x-wa-max}$ ) defines the first value indicative of acceleration of the vehicle in the first direction during the most recent manual operation of the vehicle. Instead of selecting the maximum or highest value from the set of initial arithmetic and weighted average values ( $wa_{x-i}$ ) considered as the maximum acceleration in the first direction  $a_{x-wa-max}$ , it is contemplated that a second or a third highest value of the initial arithmetic and weighted average values ( $wa_{x-i}$ ) considered may be selected as the maximum acceleration in the first direction  $a_{x-wa-max}$ . It is further contemplated that the set of initial arithmetic and weighted average values ( $wa_{x-i}$ ) considered may be averaged to determine the maximum acceleration in the first direction  $a_{x-wa-max}$ .

(74) An example control algorithm, or process, for the controller 103 is illustrated in FIG. 7 for calculating a second value indicative of acceleration of the truck 10 in the second direction during the most recent manual operation of the truck 10. In step 401, a sequence of acceleration values in the second direction from the accelerometer 1103 are collected, wherein the second direction is defined by the transverse direction TR, see FIG. 1, and stored in memory by the controller 103.

(75) In step 403, the collected acceleration values in the second direction collected during the most recent manual operation of the truck 10 are filtered with a weighted average equation so as to make maximum outliers less weighted and effect smoothing. Example equation 3, set out below, may be used to filter the collected acceleration values in the second direction from the most recent manual operation of the truck 10.

$$(76) \quad wa_{y-(i+1)} = \frac{wa_{y-i} * g_1 + a_{y_{[(i*m)+1]}} * g_2 + a_{y_{[(i*m)+2]}} * g_3 + a_{y_{[(i*m)+3]}} * g_4}{\text{Math. } g_s} \quad \text{Equation 3} \quad Wa_{y-(i+1)} = \text{calculated weighted average in a second direction (e.g., "y"); where } i=1 \dots$$

$\dots (n-1)$ ;  $Wa_{y-i}$ ; where  $i=1 \dots n$ ;  $wa_{y-i}$  = arithmetic average of the first three "start" acceleration values in the second direction for the first calculation and thereafter the most recently calculated weighted average;  $g_{sub.s}$  = weighting factor where  $s=1 \dots m+1$ , where  $m$  is the number of members in each subset;  $g_{sub.1}$  = weighting factor of  $wa_{y-i}$ ; in the illustrated embodiment,  $g_{sub.1}=3$ , but could be any value;  $g_{sub.2}$ ,  $g_{sub.3}$ ,  $g_{sub.4}$  = additional weighting factors = 1, but could be other values;  $a_{y_{[(i*m)+1]}}$ ,  $a_{y_{[(i*m)+2]}}$ ,  $a_{y_{[(i*m)+3]}}$ ; where  $i=1 \dots (n-1)$ ;  $a_{y_{[(i*m)+1]}}$ ,  $a_{y_{[(i*m)+2]}}$ ,  $a_{y_{[(i*m)+3]}}$  = three adjacent individual acceleration values in the second direction, defining a subset, collected during the most recent manual operation of the truck 10. The subset could comprise more than three or less than three acceleration values. The first three collected acceleration values ( $a_{y_1}$ ,  $a_{y_2}$ , and  $a_{y_3}$ ) make up a first subset as well.

(77) The first "start" acceleration values in the second direction could comprise less than three or more than three values and the number of members in each subset "m" could likewise comprise less than three or more than three members.

(78) For purposes of illustration, sample calculations will now be provided based on non-real sample values, which simulate collected acceleration values in the second direction, and are set out in Table 3 of FIG. 8.

(79)  $Wa_{y-1}$  = arithmetic average of the first three "start" acceleration values in the second direction =  $\frac{a_{y_1} + a_{y_2} + a_{y_3}}{m} = \frac{0.25 + 0.49 + 0.52}{3} = 0.42$

$Wa_{y-2}$  = first weighted average value =

(80) The remaining weighted average value based on the sample values set out in Table 3 of FIG. 8 is calculated in a similar manner. The results are set out in Table 4 of FIG. 9.

(81) In step 405 of FIG. 7, a maximum acceleration in the second direction defined by the transverse direction TR of the truck 10 is determined using Equation 4, set out below:

$a_{y-wa-max}$  = maximum acceleration in the second direction =  $\max(wa_{y-i})$  = maximum value of the initial arithmetic and weighted averages ( $wa_{y-i}$ ) calculated. Equation 4:

(82) Based on the results from Table 4 of FIG. 9,  $\max(wa_{y-i}) = wa_{y-2} = 0.55$ .

(83) It is noted that  $a_{y-wa-max}$  may be selected from the initial arithmetic average or any number of weighted averages ( $wa_{y-(i+1)}$ ) calculated. For example, the initial arithmetic and weighted average values ( $wa_{y-i}$ ) calculated during a predetermined time period, e.g., the last ten seconds, may be considered. It is also contemplated that a predetermined number of the initial arithmetic and weighted average values ( $wa_{y-i}$ ) calculated, e.g., 25 average values, without taking time into account, may be considered. It is further contemplated that all of the initial arithmetic and weighted average values ( $wa_{y-i}$ ) calculated during the entirety of the most recent manual operation of the truck 10 may be considered. In the illustrated example, three (3) values of the initial arithmetic and weighted averages ( $wa_{y-i}$ ) were considered. However, less than 3 or greater than 3 values of the initial arithmetic and weighted averages ( $wa_{y-i}$ ) can be considered when selecting  $\max(wa_{y-i})$  = maximum value of the initial arithmetic and weighted averages ( $wa_{y-i}$ ) calculated, which defines the  $a_{y-wa-max}$  = maximum acceleration in the second direction. The maximum acceleration of the vehicle in the second direction ( $a_{y-wa-max}$ ) defines the second value indicative of acceleration of the vehicle in the second direction during the most recent manual operation of the vehicle.

(84) An example control algorithm, or process, for the controller 103 is illustrated in FIG. 10 for calculating a maximum acceleration to be used during a next semi-automated driving operation based on the first and second values indicative of acceleration of the truck 10 in the first and second directions during the prior or most recent manual operation of the truck 10. As noted above, the first value indicative of acceleration of the truck 10 in the first direction is defined by the maximum acceleration in the first direction ( $a_{x-wa-max}$ ) and the second value indicative of acceleration of the truck 10 in the second direction is defined by the maximum acceleration in the second direction ( $a_{y-wa-max}$ ). During operation of the truck 10, an operator may drive the truck 10 quickly along a generally straight path, but slowly during a turn. To factor in the operator driving the truck 10 slowly during a turn, in step 501, the controller 103 compares the maximum acceleration in the second direction ( $a_{y-wa-max}$ ) to empirically determined ranges set out in a lookup table stored in memory to determine if a correction to the maximum acceleration in the first direction ( $a_{x-wa-max}$ ) is appropriate.

(85) As explained in detail below, the maximum acceleration in the second direction ( $a_{y-wa-max}$ ) can be used to correct, or adjust, the calculated maximum acceleration in the first direction  $a_{x-wa-max}$  when determining the maximum acceleration for the next semi-automated driving operation. The maximum acceleration in the second direction ( $a_{y-wa-max}$ ) is likely indicative of the operator's evaluation of the stability of the truck 10 and its current load. If the maximum acceleration in the second direction is greater than a first empirically derived value or within an empirically derived "high acceleration" range, then that can indicate the operator believes the load is relatively stable and the maximum acceleration for the next semi-automated driving operation can be increased. However, if the maximum acceleration in the second direction is less than a second empirically derived value or falls within an empirically defined "low acceleration" range, then that can indicate the operator believes the load could be unstable even though the calculated maximum acceleration in the first direction is relatively high. Thus, in this second instance, the maximum acceleration for the next semi-automated driving operation can be decreased. If the maximum acceleration in the second direction is in-between the

first and the second empirically derived values or within an empirically defined maximum range, then no correction, or adjustment, of the maximum acceleration for the next semi-automated driving operation is made. High, low and medium ranges (or empirically derived first and second values) can be empirically determined for a particular vehicle in a controlled environment where the vehicle is operated at various maximum accelerations in the first and second directions, various high, low and medium ranges of differing values are created and, using the maximum acceleration values in the second direction, correction factors are determined and used to adjust the maximum acceleration values in the first direction. Preferred high, low and medium ranges, which allow for an optimum acceleration in the first direction yet allow the truck to carry and support loads in a stable manner are selected.

(86) An exemplary simulated lookup table based on non-real values is set out in FIG. 11, which table contains three separate ranges for the maximum acceleration in the second direction (a.sub.y-wa-max). If the maximum acceleration in the second direction falls within either the high or the low acceleration range depicted in the lookup table of FIG. 11, a corresponding correction factor is used in determining the maximum acceleration to be used during the next semi-automated driving operation of the truck 10. If the maximum acceleration in the second direction falls within the middle acceleration range (or mid-range) depicted in the lookup table of FIG. 11, no correction factor corresponding to the maximum acceleration in the second direction is used in determining the maximum acceleration for use during the next semi-automated driving operation of the truck 10.

(87) In the example discussed above, the maximum acceleration in the second direction (a.sub.y-wa-max)=0.55. This value falls within the high acceleration range, which corresponds to a correction factor of +10%.

(88) In step 503, the maximum acceleration to be used during a next semi-automated driving operation (which may also be referred to as “a semi-automated driving operation maximum acceleration”) is calculated using example Equation 5:

(89)  $\text{max. acc} = \text{max}(\text{wa}_{x-i}) * (1 + \text{corr}_x + \text{corr}_y)$  Equation 5 Where max.acc=the maximum acceleration to be used in the first direction during a next semi-automated driving operation; corr.sub.x=a safety margin, which could be equal to any value. In the illustrated embodiment corr.sub.x=-5% (may comprise a negative value as in the illustrated embodiment to reduce max.acc to provide a safety margin); corr.sub.y=correction factor from the lookup table in FIG. 11 and is based on the maximum acceleration in the second direction (a.sub.y-wa-max).

(90) A sample calculation for max.acc based on the sample values discussed above will now be provided.

(91)  $\text{max. acc} = \text{max}(\text{wa}_{x-i}) * (1 + \text{corr}_x + \text{corr}_y) = 3.82 * (1 - 0.05 + 0.1) = 4.01$

(92) Hence, in this sample, the controller 103 communicates with the traction motor controller 106 so as to limit the maximum positive acceleration (speed is increasing) of the truck 10 in the first direction during a next semi-automated or remote control operation to 4.01 m/s.sup.2.

(93) It is also contemplated that the controller 103 may calculate a first value indicative of only deceleration of the vehicle in the first direction during the most recent manual operation of the vehicle using equations 1 and 2 set out above, wherein the absolute value of each deceleration value collected from the most recent manual operation of the vehicle is used in calculating the first value using equations 1 and 2. Deceleration values corresponding to emergency braking, which deceleration values may have very high magnitudes, are ignored in calculating the first value indicative of deceleration of the vehicle.

(94) In the event that the truck 10 does not have an accelerometer, acceleration values in the first and second directions can be calculated in alternative manners. For example, acceleration in the direction of travel DT or first direction can be determined using a velocity sensor, wherein a velocity sensor may be provided on a traction motor controller. The controller 103 may differentiate the velocity or speed values to calculate acceleration values. Acceleration may also be derived from the angular position of the travel switch 54 relative to a home position, which grip 54, as noted above, controls the acceleration/braking of the truck 10. Using the angular position of the grip 54 as an input into a lookup table, a truck acceleration is chosen from the lookup table which corresponds specific grip angular position values with specific acceleration values. Maximum velocity values may also be provided by the lookup table based on grip angular positions.

(95) Acceleration in the transverse direction TR or second direction can be determined using the following equation:  $\text{acceleration.sub.y} = \text{v.sup.2}/\text{r}$  where v=truck speed; and r=radius of a curve through which the truck moves; The radius r may be calculated using the following equation:  $\text{r} = \text{wheelbase dimension}/\sin \alpha$  Where the wheelbase dimension is a fixed value and is equal to the distance from the front wheels to the rear wheels of the truck 10; and Steering angle  $\alpha$ , which is typically known by the controller 103 as it is the steered wheel angle.

(96) The table of FIG. 5 represents a monitored drive parameter during a single manual operation. However, embodiments also contemplate monitoring and storing drive parameter data for more than a single manual operation of the truck 10. For example, data for one or more drive parameters can be monitored and stored for any number of the most recent manual operations.

(97) The controller 103, therefore, can define a beginning and an ending to each manual operation so that the data pertaining to each manual operation can remain segregated from data pertaining to a different manual operation. A particular manual operation can be considered to begin when an operator is on the truck 10, such as indicated by a presence sensor 58, and moves the truck 10 with at least a minimum speed. Alternatively, a particular manual operation can be considered to begin when a drive signal is generated via the travel switch 54 and not via the remote control device 70. It is still further contemplated that a particular manual operation can be considered to begin when the operator is located outside of the operator's station 30 and causes the truck to move via activation of the drive control switch 140 located near the top of the second end section 14B of the power unit 14 of the truck 10. The particular manual operation can be considered to end when the truck 10 remains stationary for at least a predetermined time period. Alternatively, the particular manual operation can be considered to end when the truck 10 is stopped and the operator exits the truck. Alternatively, the particular manual operation can be considered to end when the operator initiates a semi-automated driving operation via the remote control device 70. Also, a manual operation can be considered to end when an operator exits the platform of the truck 10 even when the truck 10 is still moving.

(98) As noted above, the monitored and stored data (whether from a single manual operation or from multiple manual operations) can then be used for controlling implementation of a subsequently-occurring semi-automated driving operation of the truck 10.

(99) Clearing, or resetting, the stored data collected during one or more recent manual operations can be beneficial during or after certain driving operations of the truck 10. For example, data for monitored drive parameters collected and stored while a first pallet and items carried by or on the first pallet are being transported by the truck 10 may not be relevant to implementing semi-automated driving operations of the truck 10 once that first pallet is off-loaded from the truck 10 and a new empty pallet is acquired. Thus, when a new pick operation is commenced by the operator of the truck 10, the previously monitored and stored data about the one or more drive parameters during that current manual operation of the truck 10 can be discarded or, reset, so that only new monitored data about the one or more drive parameters is used to implement subsequently occurring semi-automated driving operations of the truck 10. In one embodiment, only the new monitored data about the one or more drive parameters collected during the current manual operation or the manual operation just before the subsequently occurring semi-automated driving operation is used to implement the subsequently occurring semi-automated driving operation and any data from prior manual operations occurring before the current manual operation or the manual operation just before the subsequently occurring semi-automated driving operation is ignored.

(100) A typical stock picking operation involves an operator filling orders from available stock items that are located in storage areas provided along one or more aisles of a warehouse or distribution center. The operator drives the truck 10 between various pick locations where item(s) I are to be picked, which are typically loaded on one or more pallets P provided on the forks 16 of the load handling assembly 12, see FIG. 13, wherein the pallet P and the items I define a load L on or carried by the forks 16. Instead of a pallet, a roll cage, a freezer box or other special container could be provided on the forks 16 of the load handling assembly, wherein the roll cage, freezer box or other special container and picked items loaded on the roll cage, freezer box or other special container define a load on or carried by the forks 16. The operator may drive the truck 10 manually by using the steering handle 52 and the travel switch 54, as noted above, or operate the truck 10 in the remote control mode using the remote control device 70

for semi-automated control of the vehicle.

(101) Accordingly, the controller **103** can analyze the driving operations of the truck **10** to automatically determine a sequence of operations, or a pattern, that is likely indicative of the start of a new pick operation. Under these circumstances, the controller **103** can then reset, or discard, the collected data about the monitored one or more drive parameters that occurred during the current manual operation. The term “current manual operation” can refer to a manual operation that is currently taking place, the term “most recent manual operation” can refer to a manual operation occurring immediately prior to the current manual operation that is still taking place, the term “previous manual operation” can refer to a manual operation occurring prior to the most-recent manual operation, and the term “next manual operation” can refer to a manual operation occurring subsequent to the current manual operation. Once the “current manual operation” ends it can be considered to be the “most-recent manual operation.”

(102) FIG. **12** depicts a flowchart of an example algorithm for resetting stored data related to a first monitored vehicle drive parameter based on detecting the start of the pick operation, according to embodiments of this disclosure.

(103) In accordance with the method or process of FIG. **12**, step **1201** includes the controller **103** monitoring the first vehicle drive parameter during a manual operation of the truck **10** by an operator, i.e., a current manual operation. As described in detail above, the monitored first vehicle drive parameter can be related to acceleration of the truck **10** in a first direction.

(104) Thus, in step **1203**, the controller **103** can store data related to the monitored first vehicle drive parameter. In the example of FIG. **5**, the stored data can be individual acceleration values of the truck **10** occurring during a manual operation of the truck **10**. Furthermore, the stored data can include a calculated value, i.e., maximum acceleration of the truck **10** in the first direction, based on the individual acceleration values that are used in a subsequently occurring semi-automated operation of the truck **10**. Thus, the controller **103** is configured to use the stored data for implementing a semi-automated driving operation of the truck **10** that occurs subsequent to the manual operation of the truck **10** referred to in step **1201**.

(105) However, if the stored data includes data collected during the current manual operation occurring before a new pick operation commences, then that stored data may not be relevant to a semi-automated operation occurring after that new pick operation is initiated and completed. Accordingly, in step **1205**, the controller detects operation of the truck **10** indicative of a start of a pick operation occurring during the current manual operation of the truck **10**. Upon detecting the start of the pick operation, the controller **103**, in step **1207**, can then reset the stored data related to the monitored first vehicle drive parameter. Resetting the stored data can include clearing, or discarding, the stored data collected during the current manual operation of the truck **10** from the start of the current manual operation until detection and start of the new or most recent pick operation.

(106) Once the stored data is reset, then the controller **103** can resume monitoring of the first vehicle drive parameter after resetting the stored data. This newly acquired data related to monitoring of the first drive parameter can then be used for implementing a subsequently occurring semi-automated driving operation of the vehicle.

(107) In at least one embodiment, the detected operation of the truck **10** indicative of a start of a pick operation comprises detecting a transition from the truck **10** being manually driven with a raised load handling assembly **12** to the truck **10** being stopped with a lowered load handling assembly **12**, see FIG. **13**. In other words, the controller **103** detects that the truck **10** which was moving by manual operation has now stopped and also that the load handling assembly **12**, which was in a raised position, has been lowered. As noted above, the controller **103** can determine if the truck **10** is moving or stopped and the distance that the truck has travelled via signals from the accelerometer **1103** or motor angular velocity signals from the traction controller **106**. As also noted above, the controller **103** can determine the height of the load handling assembly **12**, i.e., whether the load handling assembly is in a raised position or in a home or lowermost position, relative to ground from signals generated by one or more of height sensors or switches alone or in combination with the load sensor **LS**. The raised position of the load handling assembly **12** would be any position above the lowermost position. This sequence of operations is particularly indicative of the start of a new pick operation when the raised load handling assembly **12** bears a substantially non-zero load and the lowered load handling assembly **12** bears a substantially zero load. As noted above, the controller **103** can determine the weight of a load on the forks **16** from signals generated by the load sensor **LS**. In FIG. **13**, the forks **16** of the load handling assembly **12** have been lowered so that the pallet **P** is no longer supported by the forks **16** and, instead, is supported by a floor **F** or other support surface defining ground. Hence, such a sequence occurs, for example, when the truck **10** transitions from moving with a loaded pallet **P** to stopping and then lowering its fork **16** completely so that the forks **16** no longer support the loaded pallet **P**. It is also contemplated that this sequence of operations may be indicative of the start of a new pick operation even when the raised load handling assembly **12** bears either an unloaded pallet or no pallet.

(108) In a further embodiment, the detected operation of the truck **10** indicative of a start of a pick operation comprises detecting the transition from the truck **10** being manually driven with a raised load handling assembly **12** to the truck **10** being stopped with a lowered load handling assembly **12**, as illustrated in FIG. **13**, and detecting movement of the truck **10** for a distance at least equal to a length of a load **L** on the forks **16** after the forks **16** are lowered, see FIG. **14**. In the FIG. **14** example, the forks **16** have a length only slightly greater than the length of the pallet **P**. However, it is contemplated that a truck may have forks with an extended length such that the forks can carry concurrently more than one conventionally sized pallet. In such an embodiment, the forks may carry only one pallet at the end of the forks or two or more pallets along the entire length of the forks. For example, a point-laser or an ultrasonic device could be provided in the second end section **14B** for sensing a distance from the second end section **14B** to a pallet, such as being positioned at the end of the forks. Hence, the truck **10** may move a distance equal to the length of a load **L** by moving only the length of a single pallet when only a single pallet is provided on the forks or a distance equal to the length of two or more pallets when two or more pallets are provided on the forks. Thus, once the forks **16** are lowered and they are not bearing any load, movement of the truck **10** (without any load on the forks **16**) is presumably indicative of the truck **10** off-loading a pallet that it previously had been bearing.

(109) The above sequence of operations is even more indicative of a new pick operation when the detected operation of the truck **10** further comprises determining that the operator drives the truck **10** with the lowered load handling assembly **12** while it is bearing a substantially zero load. Movement of the truck **10** by a distance at least equal to the length of a load carried by the forks is relevant (as noted above) but driving the truck **10** for a distance greater than the length of the forks **16** without a load is even more indicative of commencement of a new pick operation.

(110) In yet a further embodiment, the detected operation of the truck **10** indicative of a start of a pick operation comprises detecting the transition from the truck **10** being manually driven with a raised load handling assembly **12** to the truck **10** being stopped with a lowered load handling assembly **12**, as illustrated in FIG. **13**, detecting movement of the truck **10** for a distance at least equal to a length of the load **L** on the forks **16** after the forks **16** are lowered, as illustrated in FIG. **14**, determining that the operator has driven the truck **10** with the lowered load handling assembly **12** while it is bearing a substantially zero load, and detecting a transition from the truck **10** moving with the lowered load handling assembly **12** to the truck **10** being stopped with the load handling assembly **12** newly raised. In this instance, the truck **10** has travelled for some distance with essentially an empty and lowered load handling assembly **12** and has now stopped wherein, after stopping, the operator subsequently raises the load handling assembly **12**. Especially when the now-raised load handling assembly **12** bears a load less than a predetermined amount but more than a substantially zero load, e.g., the weight of an empty pallet, a roll cage, a freezer box or other special container, this sequence of operations is indicative of the start of a new pick operation. The predetermined amount might comprise the weight of a conventional empty pallet, roll cage, freezer box or other special container plus a margin of error of 1-10% of the weight of the pallet.

(111) In other words, the truck **10** had a substantially non-zero load (i.e., it was carrying a pallet **P** with items **I**) and the truck **10** then stopped, lowered the pallet **P** and the items **I** on the pallet **P**, wherein the pallet **P** and the items **I** define the load **L** on the forks **16**, and proceeded to move with the lowered load handling assembly **12**. In particular, that lowered load handling assembly **12** supported essentially no load whatsoever and, therefore, was bearing a substantially zero load while the truck **10** was moving. Afterwards, the truck **10** stopped and raised the load handling assembly **12** such that the now-raised load handling assembly **12** was bearing a load but the load was less than the predetermined amount. One such example would be when the load handling assembly **12** is bearing merely an empty pallet **P** such that an operator is about to begin a new picking

operation. Under these circumstances, the controller **103** can detect from the load sensor **LS** that the previously-lowered load handling assembly **12** was empty and bearing a substantially zero load but is now bearing at least the weight of a pallet which is more than the substantially zero load. However, the weight of the pallet **P** by itself is less than the weight of the pallet in addition to one or more items **I** on the pallet **P**; thus the controller **103** determines from signals generated by the load sensor **LS** that the load handling assembly **12** is bearing a load that is more than the substantially zero load but is less than that of a loaded, or semi-loaded, pallet. Accordingly, when detecting that the now-raised load handling assembly **12** is bearing a load less than a predetermined amount, the controller **103** may be detecting that the load bearing assembly **12** is bearing a load equal to the weight of a conventional empty pallet.

(112) As described above, with respect to step **1207**, once the controller **103** detects the start of the pick operation, the controller **103** can then reset the stored data related to the monitored first vehicle drive parameter. Additionally, the stored data can include data related to a monitored second vehicle drive parameter during the manual operation of the truck **10** by the operator, wherein the controller **103** is configured to use the stored data of the monitored first and the second vehicle drive parameter for implementing the semi-automated driving operation of the truck **10** subsequent to the manual operation of the truck **10**. Thus, in step **1207**, the controller **103** can then reset the stored data related to the monitored first vehicle drive parameter and also the monitored second vehicle drive parameter. Hence, the controller **103** can use Equations 1-5, set out above, and the stored data related to the monitored first and second vehicle drive parameters collected since the most recent picking operation began while ignoring data collected prior to the most recent picking operation to calculate a maximum acceleration in the first direction  $a_{sub.x-wa-max}$  and a maximum acceleration in the second direction ( $a_{sub.y-wa-max}$ ) and from those calculations determine a maximum acceleration  $max_{acc}$  to be used in the first direction during the next semi-automated driving operation.

(113) There are four operating conditions of the truck **10** in which it can be considered to travel and function. A first orientation is illustrated in FIG. **16** in which the truck **10** is traveling in a direction with the power unit **14** being “first,” wherein the first orientation defines a direction collinear with an axis **X**, see also FIG. **1A**. A first operating condition occurs when the truck is traveling in the direction with the power unit **14** being “first” and the truck **10** is also accelerating (vehicle speed is increasing), see FIG. **16**. A second operating condition, illustrated in FIG. **18**, occurs when the truck **10** is traveling in the direction with the power unit **14** being “first” and the truck **10** is also decelerating (vehicle speed is decreasing). A second orientation is illustrated in FIG. **17** in which the truck is traveling in a direction with the load handling assembly **12**, or forks **16**, being “first,” wherein the second orientation defines a direction collinear with the **X** axis, which **X** axis is generally parallel with the forks **16**. A third operating condition occurs when the truck is traveling in the direction with the forks **16** being “first” and the truck **10** is also decelerating (vehicle speed is decreasing), see FIG. **17**. A fourth operating condition occurs when the truck **10** is traveling in the direction with the forks **16** being “first” and the truck **10** is also accelerating (vehicle speed is increasing), see FIG. **19**.

(114) In each operating condition, the accelerometer **1103** can be configured to sense vehicle drive parameters, e.g., acceleration and deceleration along an axis parallel with the forks **16** or parallel to a direction of travel of the vehicle and an axis orthogonal to the forks **16** or orthogonal to the direction of travel of the vehicle.

(115) As noted above, an operator may stand on the platform **32** within the operator's station **30** of the materials handling vehicle or truck **10** to manually operate the truck, i.e., operate the truck in a manual mode. The operator may steer the truck via a handle **52** and may cause the truck **10** to accelerate via rotation of a travel switch **54** on a control handle **52**. Rotation of the travel switch **54** forward and upward will cause the truck to move forward, e.g., in a power unit first (PUF) direction, at an acceleration that may be proportional to the amount of rotation of the travel switch **54**, see FIG. **16**. Similarly, rotating the travel switch **54** toward the rear and downward of the truck **10** will cause the truck **10** to move in reverse, e.g., forks first (FF) direction, at an acceleration that may be proportional to the amount of rotation of the travel switch **54**, see FIG. **19**. Rotation of the travel switch **54** forward and upward while the truck **10** is moving in the forks first direction will cause the truck to brake, see FIG. **17**. Also, rotating the travel switch **54** toward the rear and downward while the truck **10** is moving in the power unit first direction will cause the truck **10** to brake, see FIG. **18**.

(116) Referring back to FIG. **2**, the controller **103** may communicate with the receiver **102** and with the traction controller **106**, all located on the truck **10**, to operate the truck under remote control in response to receiving travel commands from an associated remote control device **70** held by an operator when the operator is positioned off the truck and walking near the truck. Hence, the operator may operate the truck in a remote control mode, or as used herein, “semi-automated mode” or “semi-automated operation,” when the operator is not physically present on the truck **10** but is walking near the truck **10** such as during a picking operation, i.e., when the operator is located off the truck **10** and picking or gathering pick items from warehouse storage areas to be loaded on the truck **10**, using the remote control device **70** to operate the truck **10** under remote control in a semi-automated operation.

(117) When an operator is using the truck **10**, such as during a picking operation within a warehouse, the operator typically uses the truck **10** in both the manual mode and the remote control mode, or the semi-automated operation mode. There can be multiple, distinct manual operations of the truck **10** in-between remote control operations, also referred to herein as semi-automated operations of the truck. Each such manual operation can include lifting a load, lowering a load, and/or driving the truck forwards or backwards and steering.

(118) As noted above, an example control algorithm, or process, for the controller **103** can monitor drive parameters, e.g., acceleration and deceleration, during one or more recent manual operations of the truck **10** to be used in part to calculate a corresponding adaptive drive parameter, e.g., a maximum positive acceleration (speed is increasing), to be used by the controller **103** when the truck **10** is next operated in the remote control mode, in either the power unit first direction or the forks first direction. As also noted above, the controller **103** may comprise one or more accelerometers which may measure physical acceleration of the truck **10** along one, two or three axes, e.g., along the direction of travel of the vehicle and transverse (90 degrees) to, or orthogonal to, the direction of travel of the vehicle. It is also contemplated that the accelerometer **1103** may be separate from the controller **103** but coupled to and in communication with the controller **103** for generating and transmitting to the controller **103** acceleration signals, see FIG. **2**.

(119) In accordance with the principles of present embodiments, acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle from one or more prior manual operations of the truck **10** may be collected and stored, wherein only acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle from one or more prior manual operations of the truck **10** when the truck **10** is traveling in the first orientation such as the power unit first direction and accelerating (speed is increasing), see FIG. **16**, i.e., the truck is accelerating (speed is increasing) in the first orientation, is used to determine a maximum acceleration value for use in a subsequent remote control operation of the truck **10**. In accordance with other embodiments, deceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle is collected and stored, wherein only deceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle from one or more prior manual operations of the truck **10** when the truck **10** is traveling in the second orientation such as when the truck **10** is traveling in the forks first direction and decelerating (speed is decreasing), see FIG. **17**, i.e., the truck is decelerating (speed is decreasing) in the second orientation, is used to determine a maximum acceleration value for use in a subsequent remote control operation of the truck **10**. As noted above, the load handling assembly **12** may comprise a back cover **17** defining a load support, see FIG. **1C**, that is coupled to and moves with the forks **16**, see also FIGS. **16-19**. The back cover **17** may be located within or adjacent a recess or pocket **114B** of the second end section **14B**, such that the back cover **17** may move up and down within the pocket **114B** as the load handling assembly **12** is moved vertically up and down, see FIG. **1C**. As can be seen in FIGS. **16** and **17**, in these two scenarios, the back cover **17** of the load handling assembly **12** does not provide support for a load **L** being carried on the forks **16**, i.e., the back cover **17** does not apply a force to the load **L**. When the truck **10** is traveling in the power unit first direction and decelerating (speed is decreasing) in the direction of travel of the vehicle, see FIG. **18**, or the truck **10** is traveling in the forks first direction and accelerating (speed is increasing) in the direction of travel of the vehicle, see FIG. **19**, acceleration and deceleration values in the direction of travel of the vehicle may not be collected and, if collected, are not used in determining a maximum acceleration value to be used in a subsequent remote

control operation of the truck **10**. In these latter two scenarios, the back cover **17** may support the load **L**, i.e., may apply a force to the load **L**. As a result, an operator may operate the truck **10** more aggressively because the load is supported by the back cover **17**. If a maximum acceleration value (speed is increasing) for use in a subsequent remote control operation is based, at least in part, on data collected while the truck **10** is traveling in the power unit first direction and decelerating (speed is decreasing) and/or the truck **10** is traveling in the forks first direction and accelerating (speed is increasing), the maximum acceleration value may be skewed and may be too high for use in a subsequent remote operation of the truck **10** when the truck **10** is traveling in the first orientation and accelerating (speed is increasing), see FIG. **16**, or when the truck **10** is traveling in the second orientation and decelerating (speed is decreasing), see FIG. **17**.

(120) FIG. **20** is a flowchart of an example process for calculating a maximum vehicle acceleration for a semi-automated driving operation in accordance with embodiments described herein. The process can be implemented using at least a portion of the system illustrated in FIG. **2** such as by controller **103**.

(121) In step **1702**, the system or process implemented by the controller **103** monitors a first vehicle parameter comprising vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle (vehicle speed is increasing in the direction of travel of the truck **10**) during a manual operation by an operator of the vehicle when the vehicle is traveling in the first orientation, which, as noted above, may be the power unit first direction. Similar to the description of step **201** of FIG. **3**, a second vehicle drive parameter comprising acceleration of the vehicle along a transverse direction generally 90 degrees to the direction of travel of the truck **10** can also be monitored. The acceleration of the vehicle along the transverse or a second direction may be positive during a right-hand turn and negative during a left-hand turn. Hence, preferably an absolute value of the negative acceleration along with the positive acceleration of the vehicle along the transverse direction may be monitored and used in determining a maximum acceleration to be used by the controller **103** when the truck **10** is next operated in the remote control mode. The second vehicle parameter comprising acceleration (positive and negative) of the vehicle along a transverse direction generally 90 degrees to the direction of travel of the truck **10** may be monitored while the vehicle is traveling and accelerating in the first orientation, the second orientation or both the first and second orientations.

(122) In step **1704**, the system or process collects and stores data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle (i.e., positive acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle) comprising data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation and accelerating (vehicle speed is increasing) during the manual operation, either alone or in combination with the absolute value of the acceleration (positive and negative) in the transverse direction (second vehicle parameter). The system or process may also collect and store data related to the second vehicle parameter when the vehicle is traveling and accelerating in the second vehicle orientation during manual operation. The stored data is specifically the monitored vehicle acceleration comprising the first and second vehicle parameters when the vehicle is accelerating and traveling in the first vehicle orientation and the second vehicle parameter when the vehicle is accelerating and traveling in the second vehicle orientation during the manual operation. In step **1706**, the system or process receives a request to implement a semi-automated driving operation.

(123) In step **1708**, the system or process calculates a maximum vehicle acceleration based on acceleration data comprising at least some portions of the stored data. FIGS. **5-11** along with Equations 1-5 described above provide an example technique for calculating a maximum vehicle acceleration based on monitored acceleration data. Hence, the controller **103** may use Equations 1-2 and the stored data related to the monitored first vehicle drive parameter collected when the vehicle is accelerating (speed is increasing) and traveling in the first vehicle orientation during manual operation to calculate a maximum acceleration in the first direction  $a_{sub.x-wa-max}$ , wherein only acceleration values in the direction of travel of the vehicle in the first orientation or power unit first direction are used to calculate the maximum acceleration in the first direction. The controller **103** may also use Equations 3-4 and the stored data related to the monitored second vehicle drive parameter collected when the vehicle is accelerating (speed is increasing) and traveling in the first vehicle orientation, the second vehicle orientation or both the first and second vehicle orientations during manual operation to calculate a maximum acceleration in the transverse or second direction ( $a_{sub.y-wa-max}$ ). From those calculations, a maximum acceleration  $max_{acc}$  is determined using Equation 5 to be used when the truck is traveling and accelerating (speed is increasing) in the power unit first direction and may also be used when the truck is traveling and accelerating (speed is increasing) in the forks first direction during the next semi-automated driving operation. In the embodiment described in step **1708**, the maximum acceleration value is calculated based only on the monitored first vehicle drive parameter comprising the vehicle positive acceleration (vehicle speed is increasing) when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation (and not in the second vehicle orientation) during the manual operation and may also be based on the monitored second vehicle drive parameter comprising acceleration (positive and negative) of the vehicle along the transverse direction when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation, the second vehicle orientation or both the first and second vehicle orientations during the manual operation. Deceleration data (vehicle speed is decreasing in the direction of travel of the truck **10**) when the vehicle is traveling in the first or the second orientation is not used when calculating the maximum acceleration value in this example.

(124) Ultimately, in step **1710**, the process or system controls implementation of the semi-automated driving operation based at least in part on the calculated maximum vehicle acceleration.

(125) Thus, in an embodiment in accordance with the process of FIG. **20** vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle (vehicle speed is increasing in the direction of travel of the vehicle **10**) corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in the second vehicle orientation, which is substantially 180 degrees different from the first vehicle orientation, is not used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration.

(126) As noted above, the vehicle, or truck **10**, can include a load handling assembly comprising at least one fork and a load support extending generally transverse to the at least one fork, wherein the load support is adapted to support a load carried by the at least one fork when the vehicle is accelerating while traveling in a second vehicle orientation and decelerating while traveling in the first orientation, wherein the second vehicle orientation is substantially 180 degrees different than the first vehicle orientation. As also noted above, the load support may comprise a back cover **17** coupled to and movable with the forks **16**.

(127) Also, the vehicle, or truck **10**, can include a load handling assembly and a power unit such that the first vehicle orientation comprises a power unit first direction.

(128) FIG. **21** is a flowchart of another example process for calculating a maximum vehicle acceleration for a semi-automated driving operation in accordance with embodiments described herein. The process can be implemented using at least a portion of the system illustrated in FIG. **2** such as by controller **103**.

(129) In step **1802**, the system or process implemented by the controller **103** monitors a first vehicle parameter comprising vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle (vehicle speed is increasing in the direction of travel of the truck **10**) during a manual operation by an operator of the vehicle when the vehicle is traveling in the first orientation, which, as noted above, may be the power unit first direction i.e., the vehicle is accelerating (the speed is increasing) in the first orientation. Similar to the description of step **201** of FIG. **3**, a second vehicle drive parameter comprising acceleration (positive and negative) of the vehicle along a transverse or second direction 90 degrees to the direction of travel of the truck **10** can be monitored while the vehicle is traveling and accelerating in the first orientation, the second orientation or both the first and second orientations.

(130) In step **1804**, the system or process implemented by the controller **103** monitors a further or third vehicle parameter comprising vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle (vehicle speed is decreasing in the direction of travel of the truck **10**) during a manual operation by an operator of the vehicle when the vehicle is traveling in the second orientation, which, as noted above, may be in the load handling or forks first direction i.e., the vehicle is decelerating in the second orientation. A still further or fourth vehicle parameter comprising acceleration (positive and negative) of the vehicle in the transverse direction can be monitored while the vehicle is decelerating (vehicle speed is decreasing in the direction of travel of the truck **10**) in the first orientation, the second orientation or both the first and second orientations, preferably an absolute value of the



acceleration of the vehicle along the transverse direction is monitored.

(131) In step **1806**, the system or process implemented by the controller **103** collects and stores data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle (i.e., positive acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle) comprising data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation and accelerating (vehicle speed is increasing) during the manual operation, either alone or in combination with the absolute value of the acceleration (positive and negative) in the transverse direction (second vehicle parameter). The system or process may also collect and store data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle (i.e., deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle) comprising data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration when the vehicle is traveling and decelerating in the second orientation, either alone or in combination with the absolute value of the acceleration in the transverse direction (fourth vehicle parameter). The system or process may also collect and store data related to the second vehicle parameter when the vehicle is traveling and accelerating in the second vehicle orientation during manual operation. The system or process may still further collect and store data related to the fourth vehicle parameter when the vehicle is traveling and decelerating in the first vehicle orientation during manual operation. In step **1808**, the system or process receives a request to implement a semi-automated driving operation.

(132) In step **1810**, the system or process implemented by the controller **103** calculates a maximum vehicle acceleration based on acceleration and deceleration data comprising at least some portions of the stored data. FIGS. 5-11 along with Equations 1-5 described above provide an example technique for calculating a maximum vehicle acceleration based on monitored acceleration and deceleration data. Hence, the controller **103** can use Equations 1-2 and the collected and stored data related to the monitored first vehicle drive parameter collected when the vehicle is accelerating in the direction of travel of the vehicle (speed is increasing) and traveling in the first vehicle orientation and the stored data related to the monitored third vehicle drive parameter collected when the vehicle is decelerating in the direction of travel of the vehicle and traveling in the second vehicle orientation during manual operation to calculate a maximum acceleration in the first direction  $a_{\text{sub.x-wa-max}}$ , wherein only acceleration values in the direction of travel of the vehicle in the first orientation or power unit first direction and only the deceleration values (absolute value) in the direction of travel of the vehicle in the second orientation or forks first direction are used to calculate the maximum acceleration in the first direction. The controller **103** may also use Equations 3-4 and the stored data related to the monitored second vehicle drive parameter collected when the vehicle is accelerating (speed is increasing) and traveling in the first orientation, the second orientation or both the first and the second vehicle orientations and the stored data related to the monitored fourth vehicle drive parameter collected when the vehicle is decelerating and traveling in the first orientation, the second orientation or both the first and the second vehicle orientation during manual operation to calculate a maximum acceleration in the transverse or second direction ( $a_{\text{sub.y-wa-max}}$ ). From those calculations, a maximum acceleration  $\text{max.acc}$  (speed is increasing) is determined using Equation 5 to be used when the truck is traveling in both the power unit first direction and the forks first direction, during the next remote control or semi-automated driving operation. In the embodiment described in step **1810**, the maximum acceleration value is calculated based only on the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle (speed is increasing) when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation and/or monitored vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle when the vehicle is traveling in the second orientation. Acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle when the vehicle is traveling in the second orientation or deceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle when the vehicle is traveling in the first orientation are not used when calculating the maximum acceleration value. Because the deceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle is a negative acceleration in the second orientation, calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration  $\text{max.acc}$  to be used when the truck is traveling in both the power unit first direction and the forks first direction during the next semi-automated driving operation is performed using the stored absolute value of the deceleration values collected when the vehicle is traveling in the second orientation. The absolute value of acceleration values (positive and negative) in the transverse direction collected when the vehicle is travelling in the first orientation, the second orientation or both the first and second orientations may also be used as well when calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration  $\text{max.acc}$ .

(133) Ultimately, in step **1812**, the process or system controls implementation of the semi-automated driving operation based at least in part on the calculated maximum vehicle acceleration.

(134) Thus, in an embodiment in accordance with the process of FIG. 21 vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle (speed is increasing) corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in a second vehicle orientation, which is substantially 180 degrees different from the first vehicle orientation, is not used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration. Also, vehicle deceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation is not used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration.

(135) As noted above, the vehicle, or truck **10**, can include a load handling assembly comprising at least one fork and the vehicle or truck **10** can also comprise a load support extending generally transverse to the at least one fork, wherein the load support is adapted to support a load carried by the at least one fork when the vehicle is accelerating while traveling in a second vehicle orientation and decelerating while traveling in the first orientation, wherein the second vehicle orientation is substantially 180 degrees different than the first vehicle orientation. As also noted above, the load support may comprise a back cover **17** coupled to and movable with the forks **16**.

(136) FIG. 22 is a flowchart of an example process for resetting stored acceleration/deceleration-related data according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein. The process can be implemented using at least a portion of the system illustrated in FIG. 2 such as by the controller **103** comprising at least one processor **103A**.

(137) As mentioned above, it may be beneficial to reset any stored data regarding one or more drive parameters during a current manual mode operation once a start of a new pick operation is detected during the current manual operation. Thus, only data occurring after the start of the new pick operation may be used in calculating a maximum vehicle acceleration for the next occurring semi-automated mode driving operation.

(138) In step **1902**, the system or process detects operation of the vehicle indicative of a start of a pick operation occurring during the manual operation of the vehicle. Example techniques are provided above for different techniques for detecting operation of the vehicle indicative of a start of a pick operation occurring during the manual operation of the vehicle. In step **1904**, the system or process via the controller **103** comprising one or more processors **103A** resets the stored data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration/deceleration based on detecting the start of the pick operation. In the embodiment illustrated with respect to the flowchart of FIG. 20, the stored data comprises the monitored acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle while the vehicle was traveling in the first vehicle orientation. In the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 21, the stored data comprises the monitored acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle while the vehicle was traveling in the first vehicle orientation and the monitored deceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle while the vehicle was traveling in the second vehicle orientation.

(139) Step **1906** of the process illustrated in FIG. 22 reflects the result of resetting the stored data prior to performing either step **1702**, **1802** or **1804**. In other words, the calculation performed in either of steps **1708** or **1810** of a maximum acceleration value will be based only on stored data after the resetting occurs.

(140) U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/892,213, entitled "Adaptive Acceleration for Materials Handling Vehicle," filed on Aug. 27, 2019, is incorporated by reference in its entirety herein. U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/991,206, entitled "Adaptive Acceleration for Materials Handling Vehicle," filed on Mar. 18, 2020, is incorporated by reference in its entirety herein. U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/991,217, entitled "Based on Detected Start of Picking Operation, Resetting Stored Data Related to Monitored Drive Parameter," filed on Mar. 18, 2020, is incorporated by reference in its entirety herein. U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/943,567, entitled "Adaptive Acceleration for Materials Handling Vehicle," filed on Jul. 30, 2020, is incorporated by reference in its entirety herein. U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/249,798, entitled "Adaptive Acceleration for Materials Handling Vehicle," filed on Mar. 15, 2021, is incorporated by reference in its entirety herein. U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/249,799, entitled "Based on Detected Start of Picking Operation, Resetting Stored Data Related to Monitored Drive Parameter," filed on Mar.

15, 2021, incorporated by its entirety herein.  
(141) Having thus described the embodiments of the present application in detail and by reference to embodiments thereof, it will be apparent that modifications and variations are possible without departing from the appended claims.

## Claims

1. A method for operating a materials handling vehicle comprising: monitoring, by a processor, vehicle acceleration in a direction of travel of the vehicle during a manual operation by an operator of the vehicle when the vehicle is traveling in a first vehicle orientation; collecting and storing, by the processor, data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle comprising data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation during the manual operation; receiving, by the processor, a request to implement a semi-automated driving operation; calculating, by the processor, a maximum vehicle acceleration based on acceleration data comprising the stored data, wherein the data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle used in calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration comprises the vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle collected when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation and wherein vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in a second vehicle orientation, which is different from the first vehicle orientation, is not used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration; and based at least in part on the maximum vehicle acceleration, controlling, by the processor, implementation of the semi-automated driving operation.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the second vehicle orientation is substantially 180 degrees different from the first vehicle orientation.
3. The method claim 1, wherein the vehicle comprises a load handling assembly comprising at least one fork and a load support extending generally transverse to the at least one fork, wherein the load support is adapted to support a load carried by the at least one fork when the vehicle is accelerating while traveling in the second orientation and decelerating while traveling in the first orientation.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein the materials handling vehicle comprises a load handling assembly and a power unit, the first orientation comprises a power unit first direction.
5. The method of claim 1, further comprising: detecting, by the processor, operation of the vehicle indicative of a start of a pick operation occurring during the manual operation of the vehicle; and based on detecting the start of the pick operation, resetting, by the processor, the stored data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration.
6. The method of claim 5, wherein the maximum vehicle acceleration is calculated by the processor based only on the acceleration data collected and stored after the resetting by the processor.
7. The method of claim 1, further comprising: monitoring vehicle acceleration along a transverse direction to the direction of travel of the vehicle during the manual operation of the vehicle; collecting and storing data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the transverse direction; when calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration, using the data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the transverse direction.
8. A method for operating a materials handling vehicle comprising: monitoring, by a processor, vehicle acceleration in a direction of travel of the vehicle during a manual operation by an operator of the vehicle when traveling in a first vehicle orientation; monitoring, by the processor, vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle during the manual operation by the operator of the vehicle when traveling in a second vehicle orientation; collecting and storing, by the processor, first data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle comprising data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation and second data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle comprising data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the second vehicle orientation; receiving, by the processor, a request to implement a semi-automated driving operation; calculating, by the processor, a maximum vehicle acceleration based on the stored first and second data, wherein the first data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle used in calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration comprises the vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle collected when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation and wherein the second data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle used in calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration comprises the vehicle deceleration data collected in the direction of travel of the vehicle when the vehicle is traveling in the second vehicle orientation, and wherein vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in the second vehicle orientation, which is different from the first vehicle orientation, is not used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration; and based at least in part on the maximum vehicle acceleration, controlling, by the processor, implementation of the semi-automated driving operation.
9. The method of claim 8, wherein vehicle deceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation is not used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration.
10. The method claim 8, wherein the vehicle comprises a load handling assembly comprising at least one fork and a load support extending generally transverse to the at least one fork, wherein the load support is adapted to support a load carried by the at least one fork when the vehicle is accelerating while traveling in a second orientation and decelerating while traveling in the first orientation, wherein the second vehicle orientation is substantially 180 degrees different than the first vehicle orientation.
11. The method of claim 8, wherein the materials handling vehicle comprises a load handling assembly and a power unit, the first vehicle orientation comprises a power unit first direction and the second vehicle orientation comprises a load handling assembly first direction.
12. The method of claim 8, further comprising: detecting, by the processor, operation of the vehicle indicative of a start of a pick operation occurring during the manual operation of the vehicle; and based on detecting the start of the pick operation, resetting, by the processor, the stored first and second data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration and deceleration.
13. The method of claim 12, wherein the maximum vehicle acceleration is calculated by the processor based only on the first and second data stored after the resetting by the processor.
14. A system for operating a materials handling vehicle comprising: a memory storing executable instructions; and a processor in communication with the memory, wherein execution of the executable instructions by the processor causes the processor to: monitor vehicle acceleration in a direction of travel of the vehicle during a manual operation by an operator of the vehicle when the vehicle is traveling in a first orientation; collect and store data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle comprising data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation during the manual operation; receive a request to implement a semi-automated driving operation; calculate a maximum vehicle acceleration based on acceleration data comprising the stored data, wherein the data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle used in calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration comprises the vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle collected when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation and wherein vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in a second vehicle orientation, which is different from the first vehicle orientation, is not used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration; and control implementation of the semi-automated driving operation based at least in part on the maximum vehicle acceleration.
15. The system of claim 14, wherein the second vehicle orientation is substantially 180 degrees different from the first vehicle orientation.
16. The system of claim 14, wherein the vehicle comprises a load handling assembly comprising at least one fork and a load support extending generally transverse to the at least one fork, wherein the load support is adapted to support a load carried by the at least one fork when the vehicle is accelerating while traveling in a second vehicle orientation and decelerating while traveling in the first orientation.
17. The system of claim 14, wherein the materials handling vehicle comprises a load handling assembly and a power unit.

18. The system of claim 17, wherein the first vehicle orientation comprises a power unit first direction.

19. The system of claim 14, wherein execution of the executable instructions by the processor causes the processor to: detect operation of the vehicle indicative of a start of a pick operation occurring during the manual operation of the vehicle; and reset the stored data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration based on detecting the start of the pick operation.

20. The system of claim 19, wherein execution of the executable instructions by the processor causes the processor to: calculate the maximum vehicle acceleration based only on the acceleration data stored after the resetting of the stored data.

21. The system of claim 14, wherein execution of the executable instructions by the processor causes the processor to: monitor vehicle acceleration along a transverse direction to the direction of travel of the vehicle during the manual operation of the vehicle; collect and store data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the transverse direction; when calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration, using the data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the transverse direction.

22. The system of claim 21, wherein the vehicle acceleration along the transverse direction is monitored when the vehicle is traveling in the first orientation and a second vehicle orientation, which is substantially 180 degrees different from the first vehicle orientation.

23. A system for operating a materials handling vehicle comprising: a memory storing executable instructions; and a processor in communication with the memory, wherein execution of the executable instructions by the processor causes the processor to: monitor vehicle acceleration in a direction of travel of the vehicle during a manual operation by an operator of the vehicle when traveling in a first vehicle orientation; monitor vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle during the manual operation by the operator of the vehicle when traveling in a second vehicle orientation; collect and store first data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle comprising data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation and second data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle comprising data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the second vehicle orientation; receive a request to implement a semi-automated driving operation; calculate a maximum vehicle acceleration based on the stored first and second data, wherein the first data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle used in calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration comprises the vehicle acceleration data collected when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation and wherein the second data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle used in calculating the maximum vehicle acceleration comprises the vehicle deceleration data collected when the vehicle is traveling in the second vehicle orientation, and wherein vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in the second vehicle orientation is not used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration; and control implementation of the semi-automated driving operation based at least in part on the maximum vehicle acceleration.

24. The system of claim 23, wherein vehicle deceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation is not used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration.

25. The system of claim 23, wherein the vehicle comprises a load handling assembly comprising at least one fork and a load support extending generally transverse to the at least one fork, wherein the load support is adapted to support a load carried by the at least one fork when the vehicle is accelerating while traveling in a second orientation and decelerating while traveling in the first orientation.

26. The system of claim 23, wherein the materials handling vehicle comprises a load handling assembly and a power unit.

27. The system of claim 26, wherein the first vehicle orientation comprises a power unit first direction and the second vehicle orientation comprises a load handling assembly first direction.

28. The system of claim 23, further comprising: detecting, by the processor, operation of the vehicle indicative of a start of a pick operation occurring during the manual operation of the vehicle; and based on detecting the start of the pick operation, resetting, by the processor, the stored first and second data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration.

29. The system of claim 28, wherein the maximum vehicle acceleration is calculated by the processor based only on the first and second data stored after the resetting by the processor.

30. The system of claim 23, wherein the second vehicle orientation is substantially 180 degrees different from the first vehicle orientation.

31. The method of claim 1, further comprising: monitoring, by the processor, vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle during the manual operation by the operator of the vehicle when traveling in a second vehicle orientation; wherein the collected and stored data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle comprising data related to the monitored vehicle acceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the first vehicle orientation during the manual operation comprises first data; collecting and storing, by the processor, second data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration in the direction of travel of the vehicle comprising data related to the monitored vehicle deceleration when the vehicle is traveling in the second vehicle orientation; wherein calculating, by the processor, a maximum vehicle acceleration comprises calculating, by the processor, the maximum vehicle acceleration based on the stored first data and the stored second data, and wherein vehicle acceleration data in the direction of travel of the vehicle corresponding to when the vehicle is traveling in the second vehicle orientation, which is different from the first vehicle orientation, is not used by the processor when calculating the maximum acceleration.

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